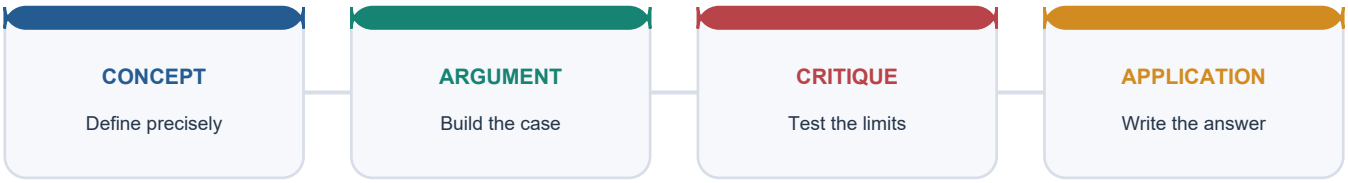
COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

The Beginnings of European Settlements - Complete Learning Session

GS-I Modern Indian History | Concepts, evidence, PYQs and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Learning Session Contents

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

The Beginnings of European Settlements - Complete Learning Session 5

BASIC LEARNING SESSION 5

Session 1: Scope: Five Stages, Not One Inevitable Conquest 5

Session 2: Maritime Background: The Indian Ocean Before The Europeans 6

Session 3: Evidence Base And Source Method 7

Session 4: Four-Power Chronology: Charters, Bases And Shifts 8

Session 5: Portuguese Arrival And The Estado Da India 9

Session 6: Cartaz, Naval Power, Diplomacy And Conflict 10

Session 7: Portuguese Trade, Mission, Printing, Crops And Cultural Exchange 11

Session 8: Portuguese Decline: Multi-Causal, Uneven And Incomplete 13

Session 9: Dutch Voc: Structure, Indian Bases And Indonesian Priority 14

Session 10: Why Dutch Power In India Remained Commercial 15

Session 11: English Eic Foundation, Early Voyages And Mughal Diplomacy 16

Session 12: Surat And The First English Factory Network 17

Session 13: Coromandel Chain: Masulipatnam, Madras And Fort St George 18

Session 14: Bombay: Crown Transfer, Harbour Geography And Presidency Shift 19

Session 15: Bengal Factories, Calcutta And The Pre-Plassey Boundary 20

Session 16: Charter, Farman, Factory, Fort And Presidency: Terminology That Decides Marks 21

Session 17: French Compagnie Des Indes And The Settlement Chain 22

Session 18: Dupleix And The Bounded Bridge To Carnatic Rivalry 23

Session 19: Comparative Infographic: Institutions, Business Models And Strategy 24

Session 20: Indian Rulers, Merchants, Brokers, Artisans And Port Communities 25

Session 21: Commodities, Bullion And The Port-Hinterland Network 26

Session 22: Shipping, Technology And Economic Effects 27

Session 23: Settlements, Forts, Urban Change And Cultural Interaction 28

Session 24: Inter-European Rivalry Before Territorial Conquest 29

Session 25: Why The English Gained Relative Advantage - Without Teleology 30

Session 26: Factory To Territorial Bridge: Conditions And Alternatives 31

Session 27: Historiography And Source Criticism 32

Session 28: Terminology, Chronology, Memory Hooks And High-Frequency Traps . . . 33

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION . . . 34

Q1. Which statement best distinguishes maritime exploration from territorial empire? . . . 34

Q2. Which contrast between the first Portuguese viceroys is accurate? . . . 35

Q3. Why were Indian textiles central to Dutch strategy? . . . 35

Q4. Sir Thomas Roe's 1615-1619 embassy to Jahangir: . . . 35

Q5. The 1623 Amboyna episode: . . . 35

Q6. Which French sequence is correct? . . . 35

Q7. Which example most directly shows ruler agency restraining a European company? . . . 36

Q8. Which statement on shipbuilding is most accurate? . . . 36

Q9. Which cause should not stand alone in an explanation of Portuguese decline? . . . 36

Q10. Which source claim requires the most caution? . . . 36

Q11. Which association is false? . . . 36

Q12. Cartaz and farman differ because: . . . 37

Q13. The printing press set up at Goa in 1556: . . . 37

Q14. How does the Danish settlement at Tranquebar fit the four-power comparison? . . . 37

Q15. Which statement best describes the French Compagnie des Indes? . . . 37

Q16. What is the best explanation for English relative advantage? . . . 38

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE . . . 38

Verified objective-demand boundary . . . 38

PYQ 01 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q33: first-quarter EIC factories . . . 38

PYQ 02 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q39: St Francis Xavier . . . 38

PYQ 03 - UPSC Prelims 2022 Q59: Dutch, Portuguese and English settlements . . . 38

PYQ 04 - UPSC Prelims 2025 Q75: Portuguese crop transfers . . . 39

PYQ 05 - Adjacent bridge: UPSC GS-I Mains 2022 Q2 . . . 39

Original Mains 10M-1 . . . 39

Original Mains 10M-2 . . . 39

Original Mains 15M-1 . . . 40

Original Mains 15M-2 . . . 40

Original Mains 20M-1 . . . 40

Original Mains 20M-2 . . . 41

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER . . . 41

Company-state and connected-history refinements . . . 41
Advanced conclusions . . . 41
ASCII master flowchart . . . 41
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES . . . 43
Register 01 - Scope, terms and the anti-teleology thesis . . . 43
Register 02 - Evidence base and PYQ ownership boundaries . . . 43
Register 03 - Four-power comparative institutional forms . . . 44
Register 04 - Portuguese Estado da India: structure and the cartaz . . . 44
Register 05 - Portuguese trade, mission, culture and decline . . . 44
Register 06 - Dutch VOC: charter, strategy and Indian role . . . 44
Register 07 - English EIC: charter, Surat and early diplomacy . . . 44
Register 08 - English coastal chain: Coromandel, Bombay, Bengal . . . 44
Register 09 - Institutional terminology ladder . . . 44
Register 10 - French Compagnie des Indes and Dupleix . . . 45
Register 11 - Indian agency: rulers, merchants, brokers, producers . . . 45
Register 12 - Commodities, bullion, shipping and economic effects . . . 45
Register 13 - Inter-European rivalry and English relative advantage . . . 45
Register 14 - Historiography, topic boundary and answer spine . . . 45

The Beginnings of European Settlements - Complete Learning Session

Subject: Modern Indian History | **GS Paper:** GS-I and Prelims

Scope: Portuguese, Dutch, English, French and minor Danish commercial settlements; the transition from sea contact to fortified company power; the Carnatic bridge. Plassey, Buxar and later territorial conquest are treated separately.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

Session 1: Scope: Five Stages, Not One Inevitable Conquest

Stage	Minimum evidence	What it does not prove
Sea contact	1498 Calicut; Cape route	control of Indian Ocean trade
Factory	Surat, Masulipatnam or Hugli warehouse-office	manufacturing or territorial rule
Fortified settlement	Fort St George; Fort William	automatic control of the hinterland
Presidency	regional council coordinating factories	independent statehood
Territorial bridge	revenue, army, alliances and political victory	inevitability from the first voyage

Plain definition: European entry into India passed through separate stages: sea contact, licensed trade, factory, fortified settlement and, only in some cases, territorial rule.

Technical definition: A stage model distinguishes commercial presence from sovereignty by testing for jurisdiction, revenue collection and sustained military enforcement rather than assuming conquest from first contact.

Exam-ready opening: The history of European settlements is a contingent progression from negotiated commerce to uneven political power, not an inevitable march beginning in 1498.

Must-write keywords: FIVE STAGES | sea contact | factory | fortification | territorial bridge | anti-teleology

How to deploy them: Draw the five-stage ladder, attach one example to each transition, and use Child's War or Colachel to prove that movement along the ladder was reversible.

Core explanation

- Maritime exploration means opening or learning a sea route. A trading presence means repeated exchange at a port. A factory was a warehouse-office-residence under permission. A fortified settlement added walls, guns and a garrison. Company sovereignty or territorial empire required enforceable jurisdiction, revenue and military power over people and land.
- The sequence Portuguese -> Dutch -> English -> French is a comparison of changing institutional strategies, not a relay race in which each power was destined to inherit India.
- Portuguese ships reached Calicut in 1498, but the Indian Ocean already contained dense Arab, Persian, Gujarati, Malabari, Tamil, Armenian and Southeast Asian commercial networks. Europeans entered an existing system.
- Use the answer spine claim -> named charter, farman, port, company, person, commodity or event -> significance -> limitation. A date without institutional meaning earns little.
- This chapter runs from the Cape-route opening to early eighteenth-century settlement consolidation. Dupleix and the Carnatic Wars appear only as the transition to armed political rivalry; Plassey, Buxar and later conquest belong to the later conquest chapters.
- At different moments Indian rulers expelled Europeans, restricted fortification, revised customs terms or used one company against another. Child's War, the Mughal capture of Portuguese Hugli and Travancore's victory at Colachel demonstrate contingency.
- Never equate a royal charter in Europe with sovereignty in India. The charter enabled a company to act; an Indian ruler's permission and the local balance of force determined what it could actually do.

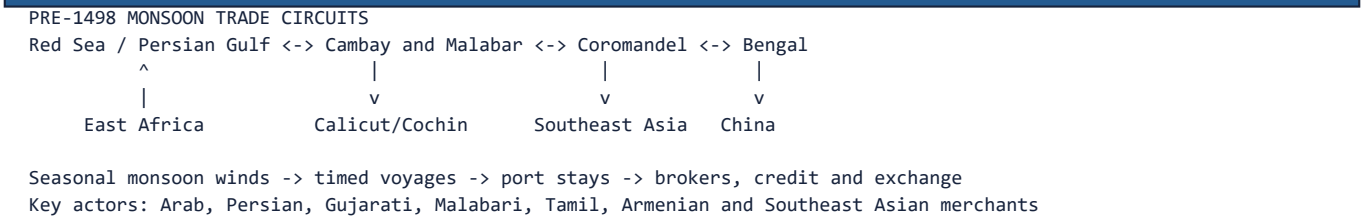
Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** A voyage, charter or factory proves presence; only enforceable revenue and jurisdiction prove territorial authority.
- **Named evidence:** The claim that European conquest was not automatic is demonstrated by three named events at different points in the timeline: Child's War (1686-90), in which Mughal forces defeated the EIC and forced an apology; the Mughal capture of Portuguese Hugli (1632); and Travancore's victory over the Dutch at Colachel (1741). Each shows an Indian power reversing or containing a European company well after that company's initial 'foundation', proving that sea contact, factory and fort were necessary but not sufficient conditions for territorial power.
- **Analysis:** Child's War, the Mughal seizure of Hugli and Colachel show that Indian states could reverse European advances long after initial settlement.
- **Qualification:** Do not treat a European charter or coastal factory as sovereignty over Indian territory.

UPSC trap: Do not treat a European charter or coastal factory as sovereignty over Indian territory.

Recall line: Contact is not conquest: identify the stage before judging the power.

Session 2: Maritime Background: The Indian Ocean Before The Europeans



Plain definition: The pre-European Indian Ocean was an established monsoon-based trading world linking East Africa, West Asia, India and Southeast Asia.

Technical definition: Seasonal winds, port brokerage, merchant credit and specialised production zones sustained overlapping maritime circuits before the Cape route redirected part of their traffic.

Exam-ready opening: Vasco da Gama entered a mature Asian commercial system whose merchants, shipyards and monsoon knowledge already connected several seas.

Must-write keywords: monsoon system | Zamorin | Calicut | intra-Asian trade | Virji Vohra | Indian shipbuilding

How to deploy them: Reconstruct the monsoon circuit before mentioning Vasco da Gama; then add Calicut, an Indian merchant and Indian shipbuilding to prevent a discovery narrative.

Core explanation

- Monsoon knowledge linked the Red Sea and Persian Gulf to Gujarat and Malabar, then to the Coromandel coast, Bengal and Southeast Asia. Seasonal winds structured sailing calendars, port stays, brokerage and credit.
- Calicut was a major pepper mart under the Zamorin; Cochin was both a rival Malabar port and a later Portuguese ally. Cambay and later Surat connected Gujarat's manufacturing hinterland to West Asia.
- Coromandel cotton textiles were crucial not only for Europe but for intra-Asian trade: companies exchanged Indian cloth for Southeast Asian spices. Bengal supplied fine cottons, silk and saltpetre and absorbed imported bullion.
- Indian merchants such as Virji Vohra and ship-owner Abdul Ghaffur at Surat, together with Armenians, Muslim and Hindu trading houses, show that European companies did not monopolise capital or shipping at entry.
- Indian shipbuilders and artisans served both Asian merchants and European companies. Bipan Chandra notes that European companies bought Indian-made ships; this is evidence of productive capability, not technological passivity.
- The Cape route altered the direction, violence and institutional organisation of European-Asian exchange. It did not create Indian Ocean commerce from nothing and did not instantly displace older routes.

- Avoid unsupported claims that a single route 'ended' Red Sea or overland trade. Traffic patterns shifted unevenly and multiple circuits survived.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** European companies depended on Indian capital, ships, pilots and commodities even while adding new armed routes and corporate forms.
- **Named evidence:** Bipan Chandra's observation that European companies purchased Indian-built ships is named, concrete evidence against a 'technological passivity' narrative: it shows Indian shipwrights supplying oceangoing vessels to the very companies conventionally read as technologically superior, while Surat's Virji Vohra and Abdul Ghaffur demonstrate that Indian merchant capital, not just European capital, financed and shipped Indian Ocean commerce at the moment of European entry.
- **Analysis:** Virji Vohra, Abdul Ghaffur and Indian-built ships disprove any claim that European arrival replaced a technologically passive ocean economy.
- **Qualification:** Do not claim that the Cape route instantly ended Red Sea, Persian Gulf or overland trade.

UPSC trap: Do not claim that the Cape route instantly ended Red Sea, Persian Gulf or overland trade.

Recall line: The Cape route altered an old ocean economy; it did not create one.

Session 3: Evidence Base And Source Method

Source family	Best use	Main limit
Charter / farman / treaty	legal claim and privilege	implementation may differ
Factory and company record	trade, prices, disputes, logistics	corporate self-interest
Missionary letter	religion, language, institution	conversion-centred lens
Indian court/customs record	host sovereignty and negotiation	elite/administrative bias
Fort, church, urban fabric	space, patronage and adaptation	later rebuilding and selective survival

Plain definition: The topic is reconstructed from company papers, royal grants, missionary accounts, Indian records and surviving material remains.

Technical definition: Source criticism separates a document's legal claim and institutional viewpoint from its actual enforcement, social reach and later physical survival.

Exam-ready opening: No single company archive can explain European settlement because every archive records power selectively and silences different Indian actors.

Must-write keywords: charter, farman, treaty | source bias | missionary letters | Court Minutes | material remains | Job Charnock caution

How to deploy them: Pair one legal text with one company record and one non-company source, stating separately what each reveals and what its institutional bias conceals.

Core explanation

- Portuguese royal correspondence, captaincy records, cartaz passes, chronicles and Jesuit letters reveal policy, shipping and missions. They also exaggerate royal command and religious success.
- VOC resolutions, dagh-registers, shipping accounts and contracts document commodity flows and local negotiations. UNESCO's Memory of the World recognition of VOC archives underlines their scale, not their neutrality.
- EIC Court Minutes, factory records, consultations, letters, charters and farmans are unusually detailed on prices, privileges and conflict. They are corporate documents written to justify expense, failure or demands.
- French company correspondence and the papers around Pondicherry and Chandernagore illuminate state-company dependence, private trade and political ambition.
- Indian Persian chronicles, farmans, customs and revenue records, port histories, merchant correspondence, temple/church inscriptions, coins and archaeology correct the company-centred view.

- A charter states authority claimed by the home sovereign; a farman states authority granted by an Indian ruler; neither proves uniform enforcement. Compare text with local outcome.
- A fort's surviving walls may reflect later rebuilding. Use material remains to establish spatial organisation and patronage, not unchanged seventeenth-century form.
- Missionary accounts are strong on institutions, language learning and local encounter but weak as neutral measures of conversion. Company records see producers through orders and prices, often silencing women and labour.
- Conventional foundation labels, especially Job Charnock as sole 'founder' of Calcutta, compress cumulative settlement by local communities, zamindars and company officials.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Charters and farmans establish claimed privilege, while local records and material evidence test implementation.
- **Named evidence:** UNESCO's Memory of the World recognition of the VOC archive is named evidence of documentary scale, not of neutrality - the same register that proves the Dutch presence in exhaustive administrative detail also over-represents company officials and under-represents the weavers and dockworkers whose labour the records exist to manage. This is the concrete case for treating 'well-documented' and 'objective' as different claims.
- **Analysis:** The scale of the VOC archive improves factual resolution but also magnifies the company official's viewpoint over that of labour and producers.
- **Qualification:** Do not treat a well-documented company claim as proof of uniform control on the ground.

UPSC trap: Do not treat a well-documented company claim as proof of uniform control on the ground.

Recall line: Read every archive for both evidence and institutional bias.

Session 4: Four-Power Chronology: Charters, Bases And Shifts

```
FOUR-POWER CHRONOLOGY: CHARTERS, BASES AND SHIFTS
  -> Portuguese 1498-1505-1510-1530
  ->   -> Dutch 1602-1605-1610-1658-1663
  ->   -> English 1600-1613-1639-1668-c.1690-1717
  ->   -> French 1664-1668-1669-1674-c.1690-1742
  ->   -> Danish 1620 Tranquebar (parallel, minor).
```

Plain definition: European chronologies contain different milestones: arrival, permission, factory, acquisition, fortification and administrative promotion.

Technical definition: A defensible timeline assigns each date to a specific institutional change instead of collapsing several stages into a single 'foundation' year.

Exam-ready opening: Chronology becomes analytical when each date identifies what changed in law, administration, defence or commercial geography.

Must-write keywords: Calicut 1498 | Goa 1510 | VOC 1602 | EIC 1600 | Pondicherry 1673-74 | Tranquebar 1620

How to deploy them: Write the chronology as dated institutional changes-arrival, factory, fort, capital or presidency-so that Goa 1510/1530 and Madras 1639/1640 cannot be conflated.

Core explanation

- Portuguese chronology begins with Calicut 1498, the Estado da India administration from 1505, Goa's capture in 1510 and the transfer of the capital from Cochin to Goa in 1530.
- The Dutch VOC was chartered in 1602; Masulipatnam and Pulicat anchored Coromandel trade, with Nagapattinam replacing Pulicat as a principal base later in the century.
- The English EIC received its charter on 31 December 1600, established an early south-coast factory at Masulipatnam, secured Surat after Swally, acquired Madras in 1639 and Bombay in 1668, and built a Bengal hub around the three villages associated with Calcutta.
- The French Compagnie des Indes was founded in 1664; factories at Surat and Masulipatnam preceded Pondicherry and Chandernagore.

- Denmark also held a settlement at Tranquebar from 1620 through the Danish East India Company. It ran parallel to the four-power spine but stayed a minor, low-political-significance presence and never rivalled Portuguese, Dutch, English or French weight.
- Dates for a 'foundation' can vary because first voyage, first permission, first warehouse, acquisition, fortification and presidency status are different events. State which milestone the date represents.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** The Portuguese, Dutch, English, French and Danish followed overlapping but non-identical settlement sequences.
- **Named evidence:** The Danish settlement at Tranquebar (1620) is named evidence that a fifth European charter-company presence could exist throughout this entire period without ever entering the four-power comparison that structures this chapter - Danish military and commercial weight never matched Portuguese, Dutch, English or French scale, confirming that an early 'foundation date' alone says nothing about eventual significance.
- **Analysis:** Separating Goa's capture from its later capital status and Madras's lease from Fort St George prevents false causal shortcuts.
- **Qualification:** Do not present the minor Danish venture as equal in political weight to the four major powers.

UPSC trap: Do not present the minor Danish venture as equal in political weight to the four major powers.

Recall line: Name the event attached to the date, not merely the date.

Session 5: Portuguese Arrival And The Estado Da India

Institution	Meaning	Exam caution
Estado da India	Crown administrative-military network in Asia	not a company or modern territorial state
Viceroy / governor	royal executive in Asian possessions	authority constrained by distance and local captains
Captaincy / fortress	nodal command and defence	did not imply inland control
Royal factory	Crown trading depot and officials	factory did not mean manufacturing

Plain definition: The Estado da India was a Portuguese Crown network of fleets, forts, captaincies and royal factories centred eventually on Goa.

Technical definition: Unlike a joint-stock company, the Estado joined metropolitan royal authority to dispersed naval-administrative nodes whose effectiveness depended on local alliances and sea power.

Exam-ready opening: Portuguese power combined Crown administration, fortified chokepoints and negotiated Indian alliances rather than continuous territorial occupation.

Must-write keywords: Estado da India | viceroy | Almeida | Albuquerque | Goa 1530 | cartaz

How to deploy them: Define the Estado as a Crown network, contrast Almeida with Albuquerque, and finish by separating Goa's capture in 1510 from its capital status in 1530.

Core explanation

- Vasco da Gama reached Calicut in 1498 through the Cape route. The encounter was commercial and diplomatic, but Portuguese expectations of monopoly conflicted with the Zamorin's established multi-merchant port order.
- The Estado da India was the Portuguese Crown's dispersed Asian administrative-military system, governed by a viceroy or governor and a chain of forts, captaincies and royal factories. It was not a modern nation-state and not a joint-stock company like the VOC or EIC.
- Francisco de Almeida, first viceroy from 1505, is associated in textbooks with a 'Blue Water' emphasis on naval security. Afonso de Albuquerque captured Goa from Bijapur in 1510 and built a nodal strategy linking Goa with Hormuz and Malacca.

- Cochin initially served as an allied Malabar base; Goa became the capital in 1530. Diu and Daman strengthened western-coast control, while Portuguese positions also appeared at Bassein and Hugli.
- Portuguese strength came from concentrated cannon-armed ships, fortified chokepoints and the ability to exploit rivalries between coastal rulers. It did not equal continuous control of the sea or inland sovereignty.
- Cochin used Portuguese power against Calicut; Gujarat rulers alternated resistance and pressured concession; the Mughals negotiated maritime access and later attacked Portuguese Hugli; these choices shaped the Estado's map.
- Do not describe Goa as the capital from 1510. Capture and capital transfer were separate milestones.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Goa supplied the Estado with a durable headquarters, but Portuguese authority remained dispersed and resource-constrained.
- **Named evidence:** The contrast between Francisco de Almeida (viceroy from 1505, associated with a 'Blue Water' naval-security policy) and Afonso de Albuquerque (who captured Goa from Bijapur in 1510 and linked it to Hormuz and Malacca) is named evidence that 'Portuguese strategy' was not a single fixed doctrine - two successive viceroys pursued materially different priorities within the same Estado da India.
- **Analysis:** The sequence Calicut 1498, Estado administration 1505, Goa 1510 and capital transfer 1530 distinguishes contact, conquest and administration.
- **Qualification:** Do not describe Goa as the Portuguese capital from the moment of its capture in 1510.

UPSC trap: Do not describe Goa as the Portuguese capital from the moment of its capture in 1510.

Recall line: Estado means Crown network; Goa was captured in 1510 and became capital in 1530.

Session 6: Cartaz, Naval Power, Diplomacy And Conflict

Instrument	Function	Resistance / limit
Cartaz	license and redirect shipping	evasion, rival fleets, local rulers
Fortified port	protect stores, artillery and fleet repair	cost, siege and narrow hinterland
Naval convoy	escort and coercion	season, logistics and manpower
Diplomacy	secure food, land and customs terms	privileges could be revised or revoked

Plain definition: The cartaz was a Portuguese maritime pass imposed on shipping through the threat of search, seizure and armed retaliation.

Technical definition: It converted naval superiority into a licensing regime that attempted to direct routes, cargoes and customs toward Portuguese-controlled nodes without achieving complete oceanic monopoly.

Exam-ready opening: Portuguese maritime power rested less on occupying hinterlands than on coercing movement between strategic ports.

Must-write keywords: cartaz | naval coercion | Swally 1612 | Hugli 1632 | Diu customs | blue-water dominance

How to deploy them: Explain the cartaz through pass, seizure and redirected customs; use Swally or Hugli as resistance evidence and explicitly deny complete maritime monopoly.

Core explanation

- The cartaz was a Portuguese pass imposed on shipping. Vessels without it risked seizure; conditions could prescribe route, cargo or port of call and helped direct customs and trade toward Portuguese-controlled nodes.
- The cartaz converted commercial aspiration into armed regulation. Named evidence is Portuguese coercion against Arab shipping and pressure on pilgrim and merchant traffic; significance lies in treating the sea as taxable political space.
- The system never produced total monopoly. Large coastlines, limited manpower, evasion, armed resistance and competing fleets left extensive Asian shipping outside effective control.

- Satish Chandra records merchant resentment at Portuguese confiscation of ships lacking a cartaz and the demand that Gujarat-bound shipping pay customs at Diu.
- Mughal rulers lacked comparable ocean-going naval power but were not passive. Akbar negotiated with the Portuguese; Jahangir's court considered English naval victories useful against them; Shah Jahan's forces captured Portuguese Hugli in 1632.
- At Swally near Surat in 1612, English success against a Portuguese squadron improved EIC credibility at the Mughal court. The event shifted bargaining power; it did not transfer sovereignty over Surat.
- Armed commerce worked when naval force, fortified supply, intelligence and local diplomacy converged. On land, the Estado depended on alliances and defensible enclaves.

UPSC traps

- **Wrong:** Cartaz was a Mughal farman for English trade. **Correct:** Cartaz was a Portuguese maritime pass; a farman was an Indian imperial order.
- **Wrong:** Naval superiority gave Portugal complete control of Indian Ocean commerce. **Correct:** It enabled coercive nodes and passes, but Asian shipping and resistance continued.
- Basic-level notes describe European naval power as a 'monopoly' that 'proved decisive'; read this as blue-water military and cartaz-enforcement dominance in this specific period, not as a claim that Indian actors had no maritime capacity. Session 22 records that Indian yards built ocean-going ships and that Indian pilots navigated the same routes; the 'monopoly' held at the level of armed convoy and coercive licensing, while shipbuilding and commercial seafaring capacity remained substantially Indian.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** The cartaz treated the sea as taxable political space and made commerce inseparable from armed enforcement.
- **Named evidence:** Satish Chandra's record of merchant resentment at Portuguese confiscation of cartaz-less ships and forced Diu customs payments is named evidence that the cartaz functioned as coercive taxation on existing Asian shipping, not as a system that created Indian Ocean trade - it redirected and taxed a commerce that already existed, which is the precise sense in which any 'naval monopoly' claim must be read.
- **Analysis:** Seizure threats and pressure on merchant and pilgrim traffic show the mechanism of coercion, while continued Asian shipping sets its limit.
- **Qualification:** Do not equate Portuguese naval superiority with the disappearance of Indian, Arab or other Asian shipping.

UPSC trap: Do not equate Portuguese naval superiority with the disappearance of Indian, Arab or other Asian shipping.

Recall line: Cartaz equals armed licensing, not total command of the Indian Ocean.

Session 7: Portuguese Trade, Mission, Printing, Crops And Cultural Exchange

Transfer / institution	Named evidence	Causal caution
Jesuit mission	Xavier in Goa, 1542; Bom Jesus tomb	mission did not equal uniform conversion
Printing	Goa press, 1556	early use was institutionally specific
Crops	papaya, pineapple, guava	network introduction, not a single-year event
Architecture	Bom Jesus, Se Cathedral, Old Goa	European forms adapted by local labour/materials

Plain definition: Portuguese contact produced religious, print, architectural and biological exchanges alongside violence and commercial coercion.

Technical definition: Maritime networks moved people, institutions, crops and techniques; local artisans and communities adapted them, while missions and the Inquisition introduced unequal power.

Exam-ready opening: Portuguese significance outlasted commercial decline because cultural and material transfers became embedded in western Indian society.

Must-write keywords: Xavier | Goa press 1556 | papaya-pineapple-guava | Goa Inquisition | Bom Jesus | cultural transfer

How to deploy them: Divide Portuguese impact into mission, print, architecture and crop transfer; add the Inquisition or coercion as the qualification and avoid precise crop-year claims.

Core explanation

- Portuguese trade sought pepper and spices, but also horses, textiles and other Asian goods. Goa connected the west coast to the Persian Gulf, East Africa and Southeast Asia.
- St Francis Xavier, one of the founding members of the Society of Jesus, reached Goa in 1542. He died in 1552 on Shangchuan Island off China, not in Goa; his remains are preserved at the Basilica of Bom Jesus.
- A printing press began operating in Goa in 1556, conventionally treated as the first printing press in India. Its early production was tied to missionary and educational needs.
- The 2025 UPSC Prelims Set A official key confirms that papaya, pineapple and guava were introduced to India by the Portuguese in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries.
- Biological transfers were networked and chronologies for individual crops can be approximate. Use 'introduced through Portuguese maritime networks' unless the source supports a precise date.
- The Goa Inquisition was established in 1560. Missionary institutions, coercive religious policy, local patronage, conversion, intermarriage and accommodation coexisted; no single label captures every region or period.
- ASI and UNESCO identify Old Goa's churches as a major ensemble of sixteenth- and seventeenth-century architecture. The Basilica of Bom Jesus, Se Cathedral and other monuments combined European forms with local materials and craftsmanship.
- Cultural exchange was causal, not decorative: maritime routes moved plants and people; Crown-mission cooperation built institutions; local artisans adapted form; coercion and negotiation shaped reception.

Must-know facts

- Xavier was a founding member of the Jesuit Order.
- Xavier died off China; his remains are in Goa.
- The annual Feast of St Francis Xavier is celebrated in Goa.
- The official 2025 Set A key for the papaya-pineapple-guava question is C: all three.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** The Goa press, Jesuit institutions, Old Goa architecture and crop transfers reveal a legacy wider than forts and fleets.
- **Named evidence:** The 2025 UPSC Prelims Set A official answer key (option C, all three of papaya, pineapple and guava) is named, verifiable evidence anchoring the crop-transfer claim to an actual examined and answered question, distinguishing it from unverifiable folk claims about Portuguese cultural transfer.
- **Analysis:** Xavier's mission, the 1556 press and the verified papaya-pineapple-guava transfer combine institutional durability with a necessary coercion caveat.
- **Qualification:** Do not assign unsupported single-year dates to individual crop transfers or claim that Xavier founded the Jesuits alone.

UPSC trap: Do not assign unsupported single-year dates to individual crop transfers or claim that Xavier founded the Jesuits alone.

Recall line: Portuguese decline did not erase print, crops, churches or Catholic institutions.

Session 8: Portuguese Decline: Multi-Causal, Uneven And Incomplete

Cause family	Named evidence	Qualification
Strategic overextension	Hormuz-Goa-Malacca chain	nodes were powerful but expensive
Company competition	VOC 1602; EIC 1600	institution mattered with naval/state support
Asian resistance	Hugli 1632; Maratha and Omani pressure	outcomes varied by region
Religious policy	missions and Inquisition	important, but not a complete economic explanation

Plain definition: Portuguese decline was the loss of strategic nodes and commercial primacy, not complete disappearance from India.

Technical definition: Overextension, weak metropolitan resources, the Iberian Union, rival joint-stock capital, Indian resistance and the loss of Hormuz, Malacca and Cochin cumulatively weakened the Estado.

Exam-ready opening: No single battle or religious policy explains Portuguese decline; several fiscal, naval and political pressures eroded a dispersed system.

Must-write keywords: Iberian Union 1580 | Hormuz 1622 | Malacca 1641 | Cochin 1663 | Hugli 1632 | strategic overextension

How to deploy them: Group decline into metropolitan weakness, rival capital, lost nodes and Indian resistance, then distinguish declining primacy from the survival of Portuguese enclaves.

Core explanation

- Portuguese decline resulted from interacting strategic, institutional, financial and political limits, not from a national character defect.
- The Estado's Crown monopoly and scattered fortress network imposed high administrative and naval costs on a small metropolitan resource base. Distance encouraged corruption, private trade and weak supervision.
- The Iberian Union from 1580 exposed Portuguese positions to enemies of Spain; Dutch and English joint-stock companies mobilised larger pools of capital and shipping.
- Hormuz was lost in 1622 to Safavid-English action, Malacca to the Dutch in 1641, and Cochin to the Dutch in 1663. These losses weakened the nodal chain.
- Mughal capture of Hugli in 1632, Omani pressure in the western Indian Ocean, Maratha expansion against Bassein-Salsette and local opposition limited Portuguese reach.
- Religious coercion and proselytising policy generated resistance, although religious policy alone cannot explain commercial and naval defeat.
- Decline meant loss of commercial primacy and strategic nodes, not disappearance. Goa, Daman and Diu remained Portuguese enclaves long after Dutch and English ascendancy.
- Do not treat Dutch or English victory as automatic institutional superiority. War in Europe, Asian alliances, commodity strategy, naval logistics and local political choices mattered.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** The Estado's nodal design became vulnerable when rival powers and Indian states attacked different links in its chain.
- **Named evidence:** The sequential losses of Hormuz (1622, to Safavid-English action), Malacca (1641, to the Dutch) and Cochin (1663, to the Dutch) are named evidence of a specific nodal chain unravelling - each loss removed one link connecting Goa to the wider Estado network, showing decline as a traceable sequence of named events rather than a vague 'weakening'.
- **Analysis:** The staggered losses of Hormuz, Malacca and Cochin demonstrate cumulative contraction, while Goa, Daman and Diu demonstrate survival.
- **Qualification:** Do not reduce Portuguese decline to one cause or describe it as total expulsion from India.

UPSC trap: Do not reduce Portuguese decline to one cause or describe it as total expulsion from India.

Recall line: Portuguese primacy declined unevenly; Portuguese enclaves and cultural influence endured.

Session 9: Dutch Voc: Structure, Indian Bases And Indonesian Priority

Base	Function	Strategic meaning
Pulicat	Coromandel headquarters and textile export	cloth for intra-Asian trade
Nagapattinam	later Coromandel centre	shift in coastal logistics
Surat	western Indian trade	access to Gujarat and West Asia
Bengal / Chinsura	silk, textiles, saltpetre	commercial depth without territorial priority
Cochin	pepper and Malabar position	Portuguese displacement, later local challenge

Plain definition: The VOC was a Dutch joint-stock corporation whose Indian factories supplied a wider Asia-centred commercial system.

Technical definition: Pooled capital and quasi-sovereign charter powers supported a portfolio in which Indian textiles financed spice purchases while Indonesian monopoly remained the principal strategic priority.

Exam-ready opening: Dutch India was commercially central to the VOC even though the archipelago, not Indian territory, received its strongest military commitment.

Must-write keywords: VOC charter 1602 | Pulicat | Nagapattinam | Coromandel textiles | Amboyna 1623 | Indonesia priority

How to deploy them: Start with the VOC's joint-stock form, show how Indian textiles financed intra-Asian exchange, and use Indonesia-first strategy to explain limited Indian territorial ambition.

Core explanation

- The Verenigde Oostindische Compagnie (VOC), founded in 1602, pooled competing Dutch ventures into a large joint-stock corporation. Its charter allowed treaty-making, fortification, war and administration in its operating zone.
- In India the VOC established itself at Masulipatnam, made Pulicat its principal Coromandel base, later shifted importance to Nagapattinam, and maintained factories at Surat and in Bengal, including Chinsura, Kasimbazar and Patna-linked trade.
- Dutch capture of Cochin in 1663 weakened Portuguese Malabar power. Yet the VOC's decisive strategic priority remained the Indonesian spice archipelago rather than Indian territorial conquest.
- Indian cotton textiles were purchasing power: the VOC used Coromandel and Bengal cloth in intra-Asian exchange for spices and other commodities. India was central commercially even when secondary territorially.
- The VOC traded in textiles, indigo, silk, saltpetre, pepper and opium within a wider Asian network. Bulk shipping, bookkeeping and capital mobilisation were strengths.
- Nayaks, Mughal officials, merchants, brokers and weavers granted land, fixed customs, supplied goods and contested monopoly demands. Pulicat was a negotiated port society, not an isolated Dutch implant.
- The 1623 Amboyna episode occurred in Southeast Asia. It matters because it sharpened Anglo-Dutch rivalry and encouraged English reorientation, not because it was an Indian battle.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** The VOC's Indian bases served intra-Asian exchange rather than a sustained programme of Indian territorial conquest.
- **Named evidence:** The Dutch capture of Cochin from the Portuguese in 1663 is named evidence that the VOC could and did act militarily inside India - yet it committed proportionally far greater resources to the Indonesian archipelago, which is the concrete basis for calling Indian territory commercially central but strategically secondary for the VOC.

- **Analysis:** Pulicat, Nagapattinam, Surat and Bengal reveal commercial depth, while the Indonesia-first allocation explains limited political ambition in India.
- **Qualification:** Do not infer from Dutch commercial strength that the VOC sought an English-style Indian empire.

UPSC trap: Do not infer from Dutch commercial strength that the VOC sought an English-style Indian empire.

Recall line: VOC India supplied the Asian portfolio; Indonesia dominated its territorial strategy.

Session 10: Why Dutch Power In India Remained Commercial

Event	Location / year	Outcome for Dutch presence
Amboyna episode	Southeast Asia, 1623	Sharpened Anglo-Dutch rivalry; helped redirect English effort to India
Colachel	Travancore, 1741	Dutch forces defeated by Martanda Varma; trade continued after
Bedara / Chinsura	Bengal, 1759	English defeated a Dutch challenge; bounded later end-point

Plain definition: Dutch power in India remained mainly commercial because the VOC prioritised monopoly profits elsewhere and faced capable Indian states and English competition.

Technical definition: Strategic allocation, not commercial insignificance, explains why Dutch factories persisted without developing a large revenue-backed Indian army or territorial administration.

Exam-ready opening: The Dutch case separates profitable trade from territorial commitment and shows that the two did not necessarily advance together.

Must-write keywords: Amboyna | Colachel 1741 | Martanda Varma | Bedara-Chinsura 1759 | strategic allocation | commercial persistence

How to deploy them: Use Amboyna, Colachel and Bedara for three different propositions-English redirection, Indian military resistance and later Dutch political decline-without turning any into instant withdrawal.

Core explanation

- The Dutch did not 'fail to see' India's value; they assigned Indian ports a commercial role inside a wider Asian portfolio whose monopoly centre lay in Indonesia.
- The VOC devoted military and fiscal resources to spice-producing islands and used Indian textiles to sustain that trade. Territorial conquest in India offered uncertain returns and heavy political costs.
- Competition with the English intensified, but the two companies' priorities differed. English withdrawal from the spice islands after Amboyna helped concentrate EIC effort on Indian trade.
- Travancore under Martanda Varma defeated Dutch forces at Colachel in 1741, demonstrating that an Indian regional state could check European arms. The Dutch continued trading after the defeat.
- The English defeat of a Dutch challenge at Bedara/Chinsura in 1759 belongs to the later Bengal transition and is used only as a bounded end-point.
- VOC financial strength could become rigidity: a centralised monopoly and shareholder expectations encouraged defence of established Indonesian returns rather than expensive experimentation in Indian politics.
- Do not write that the Dutch 'left India' after Amboyna or Colachel. Factories and trade survived after political ambition narrowed.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Amboyna, Colachel and Bedara mark different limits on Dutch political power without proving an immediate end to Dutch commerce.
- **Named evidence:** Martanda Varma's Travancore victory over Dutch forces at Colachel (1741) is named evidence that an Indian regional state could militarily defeat a major European joint-stock company outright, and that the Dutch response was to continue trading rather than escalate - directly disproving any reading of 'commercial power' as a euphemism for military weakness.

- **Analysis:** Travancore's victory at Colachel supplies Indian-agency evidence, while surviving factories show why military defeat and commercial withdrawal must be distinguished.
- **Qualification:** Do not write that the Dutch left India immediately after Amboyna, Colachel or Bedara.

UPSC trap: Do not write that the Dutch left India immediately after Amboyna, Colachel or Bedara.

Recall line: Dutch trade survived setbacks; Dutch territorial priority remained elsewhere.

Session 11: English Eic Foundation, Early Voyages And Mughal Diplomacy

Instrument / event	Named evidence	What it established
Royal charter	31 Dec 1600	corporate monopoly in English law
Naval contest	Swally 1612	bargaining credibility, not sovereignty
Factory permission	Surat 1613	licensed trading depot
Embassy / farman	Roe 1615-19; 1618 confirmation	commercial privilege under Mughal authority

Plain definition: The English East India Company began in 1600 as a chartered trading corporation seeking access to Asian markets.

Technical definition: Its European monopoly charter supplied capital and corporate authority, but Indian factories still required Mughal permission, customs terms, diplomacy and port-level support.

Exam-ready opening: The EIC's early history is one of vulnerability and negotiation rather than sovereignty granted by Queen Elizabeth's charter.

Must-write keywords: 1600 charter | Hawkins 1608 | Swally 1612 | Roe embassy | 1618 farman | Mughal customs authority

How to deploy them: Separate the 1600 charter, Swally's bargaining effect and Mughal factory permission; Child's War should close the paragraph as proof of early Company weakness.

Core explanation

- Queen Elizabeth I chartered the English East India Company on 31 December 1600 as a corporate monopoly for English trade east of the Cape. The charter did not authorise sovereignty over India.
- The first voyage in 1601 targeted the spice islands. Competition with Portuguese and Dutch power gradually redirected attention toward Indian textiles and coastal bases.
- Captain William Hawkins reached Jahangir's court after the EIC's 1608 Surat initiative. Portuguese influence and court politics limited his success.
- English naval victory over a Portuguese squadron at Swally in 1612 changed Mughal calculations. A Surat factory followed in 1613 under Mughal permission.
- Sir Thomas Roe's embassy to Jahangir from 1615 to 1619 secured and clarified trading privileges. The 1618 farman confirmed a commercial position; it was not a territorial grant.
- Early English strength lay in combining petition, gifts, merchant brokerage and naval force. Early weakness lay in dependence on Mughal customs authorities, port supplies and legal protection.
- Mughal officials saw competition among foreign buyers as potentially beneficial to Indian merchants and customs revenue. Permission was a policy choice by a powerful host state.

UPSC traps

- **Wrong:** Roe's farman made the EIC sovereign at Surat. **Correct:** It confirmed commercial privileges under Mughal sovereignty.
- **Wrong:** The 1600 charter created Company rule in India. **Correct:** It created a corporation; Indian political power came much later.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Swally improved English bargaining power, but Mughal recognition and local supply made a durable western base possible.
- **Named evidence:** Sir Thomas Roe's embassy to Jahangir (1615-1619), culminating in an 1618 confirmation of trading terms, is named evidence that even a successful, court-level English diplomatic mission produced a commercial privilege under continuing Mughal sovereignty, not a step toward territorial concession.
- **Analysis:** The Hawkins-Roe diplomatic sequence and the Company's defeat in Child's War show both negotiation and the continuing superiority of Mughal host power.
- **Qualification:** Do not convert the EIC charter or victory at Swally into ownership of Mughal territory.

UPSC trap: Do not convert the EIC charter or victory at Swally into ownership of Mughal territory.

Recall line: The 1600 charter created a company; Indian permission created its factories.

Session 12: Surat And The First English Factory Network

Rank / role	Function	Named example
Governor / President-in-Council	Coordinated trade, discipline, diplomacy	Surat headquarters
Writer / factor / merchant	Ranked Company servants, often private traders	Factory staff ladder
Indian broker / financier	Supplied credit and market access	Virji Vohra

Plain definition: Surat became the EIC's principal western headquarters within a licensed network of coastal and inland purchasing offices.

Technical definition: The factory system coordinated agents, credit, warehouses and procurement under Mughal jurisdiction; a factory was neither a manufacturing plant nor sovereign territory.

Exam-ready opening: Surat demonstrates how the English first expanded through commercial organisation embedded in an Indian port economy.

Must-write keywords: Surat factory | Broach-Ahmedabad-Agra | factor vs factory | Virji Vohra credit | President-in-Council | Bombay alternative

How to deploy them: Locate Broach inside the Surat-centred network and explain the factory as an office-warehouse under Mughal authority, not as a fort or manufacturing site.

Core explanation

- Surat was the EIC's principal western headquarters for much of the seventeenth century because it connected Mughal Gujarat, the Red Sea and Persian Gulf routes and a wealthy merchant community.
- By the first quarter of the seventeenth century, EIC factories included Surat, Broach, Ahmedabad, Agra and Masulipatnam. The 2021 UPSC factory PYQ tests this geography.
- A factory contained warehouses, offices and residences. Bipan Chandra emphasises that no manufacture was necessarily carried on there; 'factor' meant a commercial agent.
- The Governor or President-in-Council coordinated trade, discipline and diplomacy. Company servants were ranked as writers, factors and merchants and often supplemented salaries through private trade.
- Brokers, money changers, merchants, port officials, artisans and transporters made the factory functional. Virji Vohra's leverage shows that the EIC could depend on Indian merchant credit.
- Surat demonstrates embedded commerce: the EIC did not own the city or its hinterland and could be disciplined by Mughal officials. Its fortified-island alternative at Bombay later reduced this dependence.
- Do not treat every inland purchasing office as a fort or presidency. Administrative rank, defence and jurisdiction differed.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Broach, Ahmedabad and Agra extended Surat's purchasing reach without turning each office into a fort or presidency.

- **Named evidence:** Virji Vohra's demonstrated leverage over EIC credit at Surat is named evidence that the 'first English factory network' depended on a specific, identifiable Indian merchant's capital and goodwill, not merely on the Company's own charter or shipping.
- **Analysis:** The Surat-centred network explains the 2021 Broach demand through time-specific institutional geography rather than later British prominence.
- **Qualification:** Do not label every inland purchasing office a fortified settlement or presidency.

UPSC trap: Do not label every inland purchasing office a fortified settlement or presidency.

Recall line: Surat was a licensed headquarters; Broach was part of its early factory network.

Session 13: Coromandel Chain: Masulipatnam, Madras And Fort St George

```
MASULIPATNAM FACTORY, 1611
  -> access to Golconda and the Coromandel textile hinterland
  -> search for a more defensible company base
MADRAS LEASE, 1639
  -> grant through a local Nayak linked to the Chandragiri-Vijayanagara order
FORT ST GEORGE, FROM 1640
  -> warehouse + council + garrison inside the defended settlement
  -> continuing dependence on dubashes, weavers, artisans, food and the surrounding town
```

Plain definition: The English Coromandel chain developed from commercial access at Masulipatnam to the Madras lease and Fort St George.

Technical definition: A local Nayak grant connected to the Chandragiri-Vijayanagara order enabled a defended company base whose survival still depended on surrounding weavers, merchants and food suppliers.

Exam-ready opening: Madras shows how a leased trading site could acquire walls and administration without becoming independent of its Indian hinterland.

Must-write keywords: Masulipatnam 1611 | Madras 1639 lease | Fort St George 1640 | Nayak grant | dubashes | White Town

How to deploy them: Trace Masulipatnam 1611 to the Madras lease of 1639 and Fort St George from 1640, while keeping the Nayak grant and Indian urban supply visible at every step.

Core explanation

- The English opened an early south-coast factory at Masulipatnam in 1611. The port linked Golconda's commercial world and textile hinterland to Southeast Asian and European markets.
- In 1639 Francis Day and Andrew Cogan obtained a coastal lease from a local Nayak representative connected to the Chandragiri/Vijayanagara successor authority. The transaction created the Madras base.
- Fort St George was built around the factory from 1640. The fort protected warehouses, specie and staff and allowed a council to coordinate expanding Coromandel trade.
- A lease was a negotiated property/customs arrangement, not the transfer of a modern province. Company jurisdiction grew inside and around the settlement through later practice.
- Telugu and Tamil merchants, dubashes, weavers, artisans, food suppliers and revenue intermediaries sustained the settlement. Company demand could stimulate production while advances and contract pressure generated conflict.
- Fortified 'White Town' and surrounding Indian settlements evolved into a socially differentiated port city. Spatial segregation was real but never economic separation: the fort depended on the town.
- The Government of India's Incredible India page describes Fort St George as the first British garrison settlement and notes that the present site is protected by ASI and houses Tamil Nadu government institutions.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Fort St George increased security and coordination while remaining economically inseparable from the adjacent Indian town.

- **Named evidence:** The 1639 lease negotiated by Francis Day and Andrew Cogan with a local Nayak representative is named evidence that Madras originated in a specific bilateral property transaction under continuing Indian authority, not a unilateral English claim to territory.
- **Analysis:** The 1639 lease and fort construction from 1640 provide a precise sequence from permission to fortified settlement, not conquest.
- **Qualification:** Do not mistake spatial segregation inside Madras for economic separation from the Indian town.

UPSC trap: Do not mistake spatial segregation inside Madras for economic separation from the Indian town.

Recall line: Masulipatnam supplied the first link; Madras and Fort St George consolidated the Coromandel base.

Session 14: Bombay: Crown Transfer, Harbour Geography And Presidency Shift

Milestone	Date	Institutional meaning
Portuguese-English marriage transfer	1661	islands passed to English Crown
Crown-EIC transfer	1668	Company obtained the base by lease
Presidency shift from Surat	1687	regional administrative headquarters moved

Plain definition: Bombay passed from Portuguese possession to the English Crown in 1661 and from the Crown to the EIC in 1668.

Technical definition: Its sheltered harbour, defensibility and reduced dependence on Surat's Mughal officials encouraged the Company to shift its west-coast presidency headquarters there in 1687.

Exam-ready opening: Bombay's rise resulted from a staged dynastic and corporate transfer reinforced by maritime geography, not Company conquest.

Must-write keywords: 1661 marriage treaty | 1668 Crown-EIC transfer | island harbour | 1687 presidency shift | Surat dependence | Job Charnock caution

How to deploy them: Present Bombay as three milestones-Crown acquisition, Company lease and presidency shift-and connect harbour geography only after the legal transfer chain is clear.

Core explanation

- Bombay came to the English Crown in 1661 through the marriage treaty of Charles II and Catherine of Braganza. The Crown transferred it to the EIC in 1668 for a nominal annual rent.
- The sequence Portuguese possession -> English Crown -> Company lease must be kept distinct. Bombay was not conquered by the EIC and was not associated with Job Charnock.
- An island harbour offered defensibility, naval repair and lower exposure to Surat's Mughal officials. Geography created an option; investment and political conditions made it useful.
- In 1687 the Company shifted the west-coast presidency headquarters from Surat to Bombay. Surat remained commercially important despite this administrative reorientation.
- Merchants, shipbuilders, labourers and migrants built Bombay's commercial capacity. Transfer of legal title did not create an instantly functioning port.
- Bombay shows how a royal diplomatic transaction could enlarge corporate autonomy, but its growth remained dependent on Indian capital, labour, provisioning and regional security.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Property transfer, harbour advantage and administrative promotion were separate steps in Bombay's development.
- **Named evidence:** The 1687 shift of the EIC's west-coast presidency headquarters from Surat to Bombay is named evidence of an internal administrative decision distinct from the 1661 Crown acquisition and 1668 Company lease - three separate named milestones frequently and wrongly compressed into a single 'Bombay founding' date.

- **Analysis:** The 1661, 1668 and 1687 milestones distinguish Crown ownership, Company tenure and presidency status.
- **Qualification:** Do not associate Job Charnock with Bombay or describe the island as an EIC conquest.

UPSC trap: Do not associate Job Charnock with Bombay or describe the island as an EIC conquest.

Recall line: Bombay: Portugal to Crown, Crown to Company, Surat headquarters to Bombay.

Session 15: Bengal Factories, Calcutta And The Pre-Plassey Boundary

Term / milestone	Evidence	Limit
Factory	Hugli / Kasimbazar trade	no sovereignty
Settlement	Kalikata-Sutanuti-Govindapur	not created by one man
Fort	Fort William, 1690s	defensive hub, contested by nawab
Farman	Farrukhsiyar 1717	privilege, not territorial title

Plain definition: English Bengal trade grew through factories such as Hugli and Kasimbazar before the Calcutta settlement became a fortified presidency centre.

Technical definition: The conventional 1690 Charnock association, the 1698 zamindari acquisition and the 1717 farman represent different stages of settlement and privilege, none equivalent to Diwani.

Exam-ready opening: Calcutta was a cumulative urban and institutional formation, not the creation of a single founder or a grant of sovereignty.

Must-write keywords: Hugli-Kasimbazar | Child's War 1686-90 | Kalikata-Sutanuti-Govindapur | Fort William | 1698 zamindari | 1717 farman

How to deploy them: Distinguish the 1690 association, 1698 zamindari and 1717 farman, then state that Plassey, Buxar and Diwani belong to the next chapter.

Core explanation

- English trade in Bengal developed through factories at Hugli, Kasimbazar and related purchasing centres. Shah Shuja's mid-seventeenth-century permission aided Company trade under Mughal-Bengal authority.
- Child's War (1686-90) ended in EIC defeat: Mughal forces seized factories and besieged Bombay, compelling the Company to apologise and resume trade as a petitioner. This is decisive anti-teleological evidence.
- The Calcutta settlement is conventionally associated with Job Charnock's return in 1690, but urban formation was cumulative. Kalikata, Sutanuti and Govindapur had existing populations and local rights.
- Fortification began in the 1690s and Fort William became the defensive-administrative centre. The Company acquired zamindari rights over the three villages in 1698.
- Farrukhsiyar's farman of 1717 granted valuable commercial privileges and rights connected with additional villages and mint access. It did not grant sovereignty over Bengal.
- Bengal nawabs, zamindars, customs officials, bankers, Armenian and Indian merchants and textile producers determined the real operation of privileges. Murshid Quli Khan contested Company interpretations.
- Alivardi Khan's restrictions on fortification and the Siraj-Company conflict explain the next topic. Plassey, Buxar, Diwani and territorial revenue are not pulled backward into the settlement phase.

UPSC traps

- **Wrong:** Job Charnock uncontestedly founded an empty Calcutta in 1690. **Correct:** 1690 is a conventional Company milestone within cumulative settlement of three existing villages.
- **Wrong:** The 1717 farman made the EIC ruler of Bengal. **Correct:** It enlarged commercial privileges under Mughal authority.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Bengal's commercial depth preceded Plassey, while territorial conquest and revenue rule belong to the next chapter.
- **Named evidence:** Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman, which expanded commercial privileges and mint access without granting Diwani, is named evidence for the precise legal distinction this topic depends on - that a valuable, court-issued privilege is not the same instrument as the 1765 grant of revenue sovereignty tested in the Bengal-conquest chapter.
- **Analysis:** Separating 1690, 1698 and 1717 protects both the Charnock caution and the boundary between trade privileges and later Diwani.
- **Qualification:** Do not present Charnock as an uncontested sole founder or carry Plassey-Buxar mechanics into this chapter.

UPSC trap: Do not present Charnock as an uncontested sole founder or carry Plassey-Buxar mechanics into this chapter.

Recall line: Calcutta grew cumulatively; the 1717 farman was privilege, not Diwani.

Session 16: Charter, Farman, Factory, Fort And Presidency: Terminology That Decides Marks

Term	Issuer / holder	Power	Classic trap
Charter	European Crown -> company	corporate monopoly/powers	not an Indian land grant
Farman	Indian sovereign -> recipient	privilege/order	not a company constitution
Factory	company depot under permission	trade and storage	not manufacturing
Fort	fortified enclave	defence and internal control	not automatic hinterland rule
Presidency	regional company council	coordination	not equivalent to province at first

Plain definition: Charter, farman, factory, fort and presidency denote different legal and institutional arrangements.

Technical definition: They respectively describe metropolitan corporate authority, Indian sovereign privilege, a trading depot, a defensive enclosure and a regional coordinating council.

Exam-ready opening: Precise institutional vocabulary prevents an answer from converting commercial permission into political sovereignty.

Must-write keywords: charter | farman | factory | fort | presidency | company sovereignty

How to deploy them: Use a five-term definition sequence and give one legal consequence for each term; the marks lie in proving why no term can substitute for another.

Core explanation

- A home sovereign's legal instrument creating or renewing corporate monopoly and powers. Example: Elizabeth I's 1600 EIC charter; Louis XIV-Colbert's sponsorship of the 1664 French company.
- An order of an Indian emperor or ruler defining permission, customs or privilege. Examples: Jahangir-era confirmations and Farrukhsiyar's 1717 Bengal farman.
- A trading depot with warehouse, office and residence, managed by factors. It could be unfortified or fortified; it was not a manufacturing plant.
- A defensive enclosure protecting people, specie and stock, sometimes enabling internal jurisdiction. It did not by itself establish power over the hinterland.
- A regional administrative structure headed by a President/Governor-in-Council that coordinated subordinate factories, shipping, diplomacy and defence. Surat/Bombay, Madras and Bengal developed on different timelines.
- Corporate exercise of public powers such as war, treaty, justice, taxation and territorial administration. Some charters contained quasi-sovereign powers, but enforceable sovereignty in India required local capacity and political outcomes.

- Ask four questions: Who issued the instrument? What space did it cover? What power did it legally claim? What power could it actually enforce?

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Each term identifies a different source of authority and a different level of organisational capacity.
- **Named evidence:** Elizabeth I's 1600 EIC charter and Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman are named evidence of two structurally different instruments - a European sovereign's grant of corporate monopoly at home, versus an Indian sovereign's grant of commercial privilege abroad - and confusing the two is the single most common terminology error in this topic.
- **Analysis:** The distinction explains why a charter could exist without an Indian base and why a fortified presidency could still remain under host sovereignty.
- **Qualification:** Do not use charter, farman, factory, fort and presidency as interchangeable synonyms.

UPSC trap: Do not use charter, farman, factory, fort and presidency as interchangeable synonyms.

Recall line: Charter creates company; farman grants privilege; factory trades; fort defends; presidency coordinates.

Session 17: French Compagnie Des Indes And The Settlement Chain

Year	Milestone
1664	Compagnie des Indes chartered under Colbert / Louis XIV
1668-69	Factories at Surat and Masulipatnam
1673-74	Pondicherry acquired, developed under Francois Martin
c.1690-92	Chandernagore established in Bengal

Plain definition: The French Compagnie des Indes built a settlement chain from Surat and Masulipatnam to Pondicherry and Chandernagore.

Technical definition: A state-backed monopoly company combined royal subsidy with Asian trade, but its bases depended on Indian merchants, weavers, brokers and political permission.

Exam-ready opening: French settlement was commercially capable and locally embedded, yet unusually exposed to changes in metropolitan policy and war.

Must-write keywords: Colbert 1664 | Surat-Masulipatnam factories | Pondicherry 1673-74 | Francois Martin | Chandernagore | four-company spine

How to deploy them: Build the French chain from the 1664 company through Surat, Masulipatnam, Pondicherry and Chandernagore, then weigh local commercial strength against metropolitan dependence.

Core explanation

- Jean-Baptiste Colbert sponsored the French Compagnie des Indes Orientales in 1664 under Louis XIV. It was a state-backed monopoly company, not simply a ministry and not as continuously autonomous as the EIC.
- French factories at Surat (1668) and Masulipatnam (1669) preceded Pondicherry, acquired in 1673-74 and developed under Francois Martin.
- Chandernagore in Bengal emerged around 1690-92 as a commercial base. Mahe, Yanam and Karaikal later completed a dispersed network, but the four-company spine remains Portuguese-Dutch-English-French.
- French merchants sought Indian textiles and other Asian goods. Pondicherry's success depended on Tamil merchants, weavers, brokers, tax farmers and surrounding political authorities.
- Pondicherry's grid and differentiated quarters are useful architectural evidence, but the planned town was repeatedly altered by war and rebuilding.
- French royal subsidy could mobilise resources yet also exposed the company to policy reversals, bureaucratic control and competition with France's continental and Atlantic priorities.
- Avoid explaining later French defeat only through Dupleix or Lally. Company finance, naval support, home-state priorities, English credit and Indian alliances all mattered.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Pondicherry became the main French centre because trade, planned urban space and regional brokerage converged there.
- **Named evidence:** Francois Martin's development of Pondicherry after its 1673-74 acquisition is named evidence that French settlement, like the other three powers, depended on a specific administrator translating a royal charter into a functioning port, rather than the 1664 Compagnie charter alone producing a settlement.
- **Analysis:** The 1664 company, 1668-69 factories and 1673-74 Pondicherry acquisition establish a settlement sequence before the later Carnatic challenge.
- **Qualification:** Do not explain French outcomes solely through the personalities of Dupleix or Lally.

UPSC trap: Do not explain French outcomes solely through the personalities of Dupleix or Lally.

Recall line: French chain: company 1664, early factories, Pondicherry 1673-74, Chandernagore.

Session 18: Dupleix And The Bounded Bridge To Carnatic Rivalry

Year	Dupleix milestone
1731	Governor of Chandernagore
1742	Governor-general at Pondicherry
1746	First Carnatic War begins; French capture Madras

Plain definition: Dupleix used French commercial and military resources to intervene in Carnatic and Hyderabad succession disputes.

Technical definition: This strategy exchanged trained troops and company support for claimant influence, creating a bridge from fortified commerce to political leverage without yet constituting broad territorial sovereignty.

Exam-ready opening: Dupleix marks the moment when European company rivalry fused with Indian claimant politics in south India.

Must-write keywords: Dupleix | Chandernagore 1731 | Pondicherry 1742 | First Carnatic War 1746 | Nawab of the Carnatic | political concession

How to deploy them: Use Dupleix to demonstrate the mechanism of claimant support, trained troops and political leverage; stop before converting this bridge into a full conquest narrative.

Core explanation

- Dupleix became governor of Chandernagore in 1731 and governor-general at Pondicherry in 1742. He expanded trade and recognised that European-trained troops could influence succession disputes.
- The Carnatic bridge joined three arenas: European wars, rival Indian claimants and company military-financial competition. None can be treated as background decoration.
- The First Carnatic War began in 1746 as the War of Austrian Succession reached India. French capture of Madras and the battle at St Thome exposed the effectiveness of disciplined infantry and artillery.
- The Nawab of the Carnatic intervened because foreign companies were fighting within his claimed jurisdiction. Indian succession claimants then sought company support for their own objectives.
- Dupleix did not invent Indian political rivalry; he inserted company resources into existing disputes and converted military service into territorial or fiscal concessions.
- Detailed war chronology, Arcot, Wandiwash 1760 and the Treaty of Paris 1763 belong to the next stage. Here they show only that settlements could become political bases under contingent conditions.
- French political defeat did not erase French settlements. Paris restored limited commercial presence while restricting political-military ambition.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** The Carnatic transition depended on both European war and choices made by Indian rulers and contenders.

- **Named evidence:** Dupleix's appointments as governor of Chandernagore (1731) and governor-general at Pondicherry (1742), followed by the French capture of Madras during the First Carnatic War (1746), are named evidence of the precise sequence by which a company official's trade-and-alliance career converted into a war-fighting political actor - the exact 'bridge' mechanism this session is named for.
- **Analysis:** The First and Second Carnatic Wars show how settlement resources could support political clients, while the chapter boundary prevents later conquest from being read backward.
- **Qualification:** Do not portray the Carnatic Wars as purely European conflicts fought on a passive Indian stage.

UPSC trap: Do not portray the Carnatic Wars as purely European conflicts fought on a passive Indian stage.

Recall line: Dupleix turned settlement capacity into claimant politics; he did not make conquest inevitable.

Session 19: Comparative Infographic: Institutions, Business Models And Strategy

```
COMPARATIVE INFOGRAPHIC: INSTITUTIONS, BUSINESS MODELS AND STRATEGY
  -> Portuguese Crown Estado and armed monopoly
  ->   -> Dutch joint-stock VOC and Indonesia-first intra-Asian trade
  ->   -> English chartered EIC and multi-coast fortified hubs
  ->   -> French state-sponsored Compagnie and Coromandel-Bengal focus.
```

Plain definition: The four major European powers used different institutional and financial models in India.

Technical definition: The Portuguese Crown Estado, Dutch joint-stock VOC, English chartered EIC and French state-backed Compagnie differed in capital, home-state dependence, geographic priority and enforceable power.

Exam-ready opening: Comparison explains divergent outcomes better than a single narrative of European superiority.

Must-write keywords: Estado | VOC | EIC | Compagnie des Indes | joint-stock | royal charter

How to deploy them: Compare the four powers under the same headings-ownership, finance, geography and Indian dependence-before judging why their political outcomes diverged.

Core explanation

- Portuguese power was a Crown-centred fortress-and-fleet system; the VOC and EIC were joint-stock corporations with different geographic priorities; the French company combined monopoly commerce with close royal sponsorship.
- Portuguese strategy concentrated on western chokepoints and shipping passes. Dutch strategy integrated Indian goods into an Indonesia-first network. English strategy accumulated a multi-coast chain. French strategy centred on Coromandel-Bengal trade and later claimant politics.
- Strength cannot be reduced to 'private beats state'. The EIC depended on royal charter and Royal Navy; the VOC had quasi-sovereign public powers; the Portuguese Crown tolerated private trade; the French company also contained private enterprise.
- The decisive variable changed over time: naval cannon mattered at entry, textiles and bullion sustained commerce, fortified hubs reduced risk, political alliances opened intervention and only later did revenue finance territorial war.
- Company categories were evolving institutions. Avoid projecting nineteenth-century colonial bureaucracies backward onto seventeenth-century factories.

Variable	Portuguese	Dutch	English	French
Political form	Crown Estado	chartered VOC	chartered EIC	state-sponsored company
Core finance	royal monopoly/revenue	joint stock + Asian trade	joint stock + credit/private trade	capital + royal subsidy
Priority	sea lanes and forts	Indonesia spice system	Indian multi-coast network	Pondicherry/Bengal and rivalry
Indian limit	thin manpower/local resistance	territory secondary	host-state dependence before 1757	finance/naval/home-state discontinuity

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Institutional form shaped strategic options but never operated independently of Indian politics and commercial geography.
- **Named evidence:** Placing the Estado's Crown monopoly, the VOC's Indonesia-first joint stock, the EIC's multi-coast chartered network and the French Compagnie's royal-subsidy model side by side is named evidence that 'European power in India' was never one institution - each company's Indian outcome tracked its own distinct financial and geographic strategy.
- **Analysis:** Contrasting chokepoint coercion, Indonesia-first trade, a multi-coast network and French claimant intervention reveals four distinct trajectories.
- **Qualification:** Do not project nineteenth-century colonial bureaucracies backward onto seventeenth-century companies.

UPSC trap: Do not project nineteenth-century colonial bureaucracies backward onto seventeenth-century companies.

Recall line: Compare form, finance, geography and Indian dependence before comparing outcomes.

Session 20: Indian Rulers, Merchants, Brokers, Artisans And Port Communities

Actor	Named evidence	How agency changed outcomes
Ruler	Zamorin, Cochin, Jahangir, Aurangzeb, Nayaks, Bengal nawabs	grant, restriction, alliance, expulsion
Merchant / banker	Virji Vohra, Abdul Ghaffur, Armenians	credit, shipping, information, market access
Broker / dubash	port intermediaries	translation, procurement, customs negotiation
Producer / shipbuilder	Coromandel and Bengal weavers; Indian yards	quality, supply, technology and bargaining

Plain definition: European settlements were co-produced by Indian rulers, financiers, brokers, artisans, labourers and surrounding port communities.

Technical definition: Indian actors supplied legal permission, credit, procurement, intelligence, shipping, production and food while negotiating within an increasingly unequal military-corporate relationship.

Exam-ready opening: A company fort could defend goods, but it could not function without the Indian society beyond its walls.

Must-write keywords: Zamorin | Aurangzeb | Virji Vohra | dubashes | weavers | port society

How to deploy them: Organise Indian agency by rulers, financiers, brokers and labour; give each group a named action and end by distinguishing agency from equality of power.

Core explanation

- The Zamorin resisted Portuguese monopoly; Cochin allied with them; Gujarat rulers negotiated Diu and Bassein under pressure; Mughal emperors balanced Portuguese and English maritime utility; local Nayaks granted Madras land; Bengal nawabs restricted fortification.
- Aurangzeb's government defeated the EIC in Child's War and restored trade on submission. Martanda Varma's Travancore defeated the Dutch at Colachel. These events disprove a passive-stage narrative.
- Virji Vohra and Abdul Ghaffur at Surat, Armenian networks in Bengal and large Indian commercial houses supplied credit, ships, information and markets beyond company command.
- Dubashes and brokers translated language, law, price and social access. Their brokerage created influence and opportunities but also made them targets in disputes over corruption and monopoly.
- Weavers, dyers, spinners, carpenters, dockworkers and shipbuilders turned orders into exports. Advance contracts could provide demand and credit while also enabling coercion and quality control.

- Food suppliers, labourers, religious communities, women in household production and service groups made settlements viable, though company archives under-record them.
- Agency did not mean equality. Naval artillery, armed forts and corporate legal privilege created asymmetry; Indian actors nevertheless bargained, resisted, collaborated and redirected outcomes.
- Europeans gained footholds through Indian political permission and economic interdependence before they gained power through revenue and war.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Indian agency shaped the location, survival and direction of every early European settlement.
- **Named evidence:** Aurangzeb's defeat of the EIC in Child's War, followed by the Company's submission and restoration of trade, is named evidence that a single Mughal ruler could reverse an English company's position outright - the clearest available case against reading 'Indian agency' as a passive or merely economic role.
- **Analysis:** Rulers could permit or expel, merchants could finance or redirect trade, and workers could sustain production; together they explain negotiated growth before conquest.
- **Qualification:** Do not confuse Indian participation with equality of power or erase the asymmetry created by guns, forts and corporate privilege.

UPSC trap: Do not confuse Indian participation with equality of power or erase the asymmetry created by guns, forts and corporate privilege.

Recall line: European walls depended on Indian permission, credit, labour and supply.

Session 21: Commodities, Bullion And The Port-Hinterland Network

```
COMMODITIES, BULLION AND THE PORT-HINTERLAND NETWORK
  -> markets send bullion, credit, orders and shipping to Indian port society
  ->   -> ports and hinterlands send cotton textiles, pepper, silk, indigo and saltpetre
  ->      outward
  ->   -> rulers, brokers, merchants, artisans and shipbuilders mediate all flows.
```

Plain definition: European companies bought Indian pepper, textiles, silk, indigo and saltpetre with bullion and redistributed them through global and intra-Asian markets.

Technical definition: Each port depended on a commodity hinterland, merchant credit and transport chain, so maritime trade must be analysed as a port-hinterland network rather than an isolated coastal exchange.

Exam-ready opening: The factory connected an Indian production zone to oceanic finance; the port was only one node in that chain.

Must-write keywords: pepper | cotton textiles | saltpetre | bullion inflow | hinterland | intra-Asian exchange

How to deploy them: Move from commodity to production zone to port to bullion or credit, using one western and one eastern circuit to show why a factory depended on its hinterland.

Core explanation

- Malabar pepper and Asian spices drew Portuguese attention, but European companies rapidly depended on Indian cotton textiles, silk, indigo, saltpetre and other goods.
- Gujarat and Coromandel supplied cotton textiles; Bengal supplied cottons and silk; Bihar-Patna was associated with saltpetre; Malabar with pepper; horses came through western maritime routes for Indian armies.
- Because Asian producers sold more to European companies than they bought in European goods, bullion flowed into Indian and Asian markets to settle trade. Sekhar Bandyopadhyay notes Bengal's favourable balance and absorption of company bullion into its cash economy.
- Intra-Asian trade mattered: Indian cloth bought Southeast Asian spices; shipping connected the Persian Gulf, Red Sea, Bay of Bengal and archipelago.
- A port represented inland systems of cultivation, spinning, weaving, dyeing, transport, money changing, credit and customs. The coast cannot be studied without production zones.
- Company demand could expand output, specialise quality and strengthen some merchant groups. Monopoly pressure, forced advances, naval coercion and war could also redirect or damage trade.

- Avoid unsupported aggregate tonnage or bullion totals. Direction and mechanism are better established than a single all-India quantity.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Commodity geography explains why companies clustered at Malabar, Gujarat, Coromandel, Bengal and Bihar-linked routes.
- **Named evidence:** Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's account of Bengal's favourable trade balance, absorbing company bullion into its own cash economy, is named evidence for the bullion-inflow mechanism this session describes - a specific named region and a specific named historian's finding, not an unattributed generalisation about 'trade balance'.
- **Analysis:** Pepper, cotton, silk and saltpetre tie named ports to named producers and show why bullion inflow reflected Europe's limited reciprocal demand in India.
- **Qualification:** Do not use unsupported aggregate bullion or tonnage figures when named commodity circuits provide safer evidence.

UPSC trap: Do not use unsupported aggregate bullion or tonnage figures when named commodity circuits provide safer evidence.

Recall line: Port plus hinterland plus commodity plus credit equals the trade network.

Session 22: Shipping, Technology And Economic Effects

Domain	European strength	Indian contribution
Shipbuilding	Integrated military-maritime system	Indian yards built the vessels; English shipbuilding learned from Indian technique
Navigation	Oceanic route knowledge	Asian pilots understood monsoons and coasts
Finance	Joint-stock capital pooling	Indian credit, advances and reinvestment

Plain definition: European maritime advantage came from an integrated system of armed ships, artillery, finance, logistics and corporate organisation.

Technical definition: Systems comparison distinguishes naval coercive capacity from navigational knowledge and shipbuilding skill, both of which remained substantial among Indian and Asian actors.

Exam-ready opening: Technology mattered through organisation and sustained finance, not through a simple civilisational ranking of Europeans over Indians.

Must-write keywords: Portuguese naval-artillery system | Indian pilots | joint-stock finance | textile advances | port growth | deindustrialisation caution

How to deploy them: Compare the complete military-maritime systems rather than isolated ships; balance artillery and logistics with Asian pilots and Indian-built vessels.

Core explanation

- Portuguese ships combined oceanic navigation, heavy artillery and fortified resupply. Their advantage was an integrated military-maritime system, not a claim that Indian sailors lacked navigational knowledge.
- Asian pilots understood monsoons and coasts; Indian yards built vessels for Indian merchants and European companies. Bipan Chandra records an English observer's judgement that English shipbuilding learned much from Indians.
- Joint-stock capital spread risk across voyages, while bills, private trade and Asian reinvestment increased flexibility. Corporate finance mattered most when linked to naval protection and political privilege.
- Textile orders transmitted specifications, advances and inspection into weaving zones. Producers could bargain or shift buyers when competition existed; monopoly and debt could narrow that space.
- Ports attracted migrants, service occupations, warehouses, mint/customs activity and religious institutions. Growth could coexist with disease, fire, war and unequal jurisdiction.

- Early European settlement did not yet produce the nineteenth-century deindustrialisation pattern. The seventeenth and early eighteenth centuries often saw strong demand for Indian manufactures.
- The key transition was organisational: companies connected armed shipping, corporate accounting, distant credit and fortified bases to Indian production networks.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** European fleets could project concentrated force while still relying on Asian pilots, Indian shipyards and local supplies.
- **Named evidence:** Bipan Chandra's recorded observation that English shipbuilding itself learned from Indian technique is named evidence directly countering a 'technologically passive India' narrative - reinforcing this session's core claim that European advantage was organisational integration, not a monopoly on nautical knowledge.
- **Analysis:** Indian-built ships and monsoon expertise qualify the claim of superiority without denying the military effect of convoyed artillery and naval logistics.
- **Qualification:** Do not turn European naval coercion into a claim that Indians lacked ships, pilots or ocean-going knowledge.

UPSC trap: Do not turn European naval coercion into a claim that Indians lacked ships, pilots or ocean-going knowledge.

Recall line: Compare systems of force; do not deny Indian maritime skill.

Session 23: Settlements, Forts, Urban Change And Cultural Interaction

Site	Institutional signature	Historical caution
Goa	Estado capital, churches, naval hub	not the whole Portuguese Asian empire
Pulicat	VOC textile base	Indian port society predates company dominance
Madras	Fort St George and council	lease and town grew cumulatively
Bombay	island harbour and presidency	Crown-EIC transfer was staged
Calcutta	three villages and Fort William	Charnock label is disputed
Pondicherry	French company and planned town	war/rebuilding altered fabric

Plain definition: European settlements formed layered port cities in which a defended company enclave depended on a larger Indian commercial and residential town.

Technical definition: Fortification organised jurisdiction and defence, while brokers, artisans, religious institutions and mixed communities produced urban interaction beyond the walls.

Exam-ready opening: Goa, Madras, Bombay, Calcutta and Pondicherry were connected urban societies, not sealed European islands.

Must-write keywords: Goa | Madras | Bombay | Calcutta | Pondicherry | layered sovereignty

How to deploy them: Read the fort and town together: identify the defended enclave, the Indian market and local adaptation, then explain why surviving stone overstates corporate autonomy.

Core explanation

- Fortification protected high-value stock and specie, concentrated company personnel and signalled a claim to internal jurisdiction. It could also alarm host rulers, as Bengal's fortification disputes demonstrate.
- Goa combined Crown, military and ecclesiastical institutions; Madras grew around Fort St George; Bombay used island-harbour geography; Calcutta joined three villages to Fort William; Pondicherry expressed a French grid through repeated rebuilding.

- European enclaves depended on surrounding Indian towns for food, textiles, labour, language, brokerage, taxation and family life. Walls separated jurisdiction more reliably than economy.
- Indo-Portuguese churches and houses, the Goa press, Christian communities, loanwords and crop transfers show long interaction. French and English settlements created new architectural and administrative forms.
- 'European architecture' was never simply imported. Local masons, woodworkers, materials, climate and patronage adapted forms. UNESCO describes Old Goa as a fusion of European styles and local conditions.
- Heritage survival is selective. Forts and churches preserve elite institutions better than workers' quarters, weaving households, docks and temporary markets.
- The settlement was a laboratory of layered sovereignty: company rules inside, Indian authority outside and contested zones between.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Settlement architecture records both corporate power and adaptation by local labour, materials and social networks.
- **Named evidence:** UNESCO's description of Old Goa's churches as a fusion of European architectural forms with local materials and labour is named evidence that even the most Crown-centred, ecclesiastical European settlement in this topic was materially produced by Indian masons and craftsmen, not imported wholesale.
- **Analysis:** The contrast between durable forts and less visible markets explains why material remains can overstate European autonomy and understate Indian urban contribution.
- **Qualification:** Do not describe European architecture or urban culture as simply imported without local adaptation.

UPSC trap: Do not describe European architecture or urban culture as simply imported without local adaptation.

Recall line: The fort was visible; the Indian town made it viable.

Session 24: Inter-European Rivalry Before Territorial Conquest

Rivalry pair	Named flashpoint	Effect
Portuguese-Dutch	Cochin captured, 1663	Portuguese Malabar power weakened
Portuguese-English	Swally, 1612	Shifted Mughal perception of naval utility
Dutch-English	Amboyna, 1623	Sharpened rivalry; redirected English to India
Anglo-French	Carnatic, from 1746	Fused European war with Indian succession politics

Plain definition: Before territorial conquest, European powers competed through naval clashes, port seizures, diplomacy and restrictions on rival trade.

Technical definition: Portuguese-Dutch, Portuguese-English, Dutch-English and Anglo-French rivalry shifted across Swally, Cochin, Amboyna and the Carnatic as European wars intersected with Indian choices.

Exam-ready opening: Inter-European rivalry in India changed location and form as companies moved from maritime competition toward political intervention.

Must-write keywords: Cochin 1663 | Swally 1612 | Amboyna 1623 | Carnatic War 1746 | host-ruler management | fragmented authority

How to deploy them: Arrange rivalry chronologically from Swally and Amboyna to the Carnatic, identifying at each point which Indian ruler, port or political dispute altered the contest.

Core explanation

- Dutch attacks displaced Portuguese positions across Asia and at Cochin. Rivalry linked European war, company strategy and Asian alliances.
- Swally changed Mughal perceptions of naval utility. English advance at Surat depended on both battlefield credibility and Mughal permission.
- Amboyna in 1623 sharpened rivalry in Southeast Asia and helped redirect English effort. In India, competition centred on textiles, prices, suppliers and shipping as much as battle.

- By the 1740s Madras and Pondicherry were fortified commercial hubs capable of supporting war. The Carnatic transition fused European conflict with Indian succession politics.
- Host rulers were not neutral referees. They used customs, fortification bans, alliances and military action to manage companies, though fragmented authority could widen company room for manoeuvre.
- Rivalry raised demand and bargaining opportunities for some Indian merchants, but it also militarised ports, disrupted shipping and encouraged fortification.
- Wandiwash 1760 and Paris 1763 explain the later outcome, not the nature of the first century of settlement.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** European conflict was never insulated from host rulers who permitted, balanced, resisted or allied with competing companies.
- **Named evidence:** The 1623 Amboyna episode, which sharpened Anglo-Dutch rivalry and helped redirect English company effort toward India, is named evidence that inter-European rivalry outside India (in the Indonesian archipelago) could still reshape the settlement pattern inside India - rivalry was never a purely Indian-soil phenomenon.
- **Analysis:** The sequence from Swally and Amboyna to the Carnatic shows escalation without making every early clash a territorial war.
- **Qualification:** Do not merge distinct rivalries or treat every company conflict as a direct step toward conquest.

UPSC trap: Do not merge distinct rivalries or treat every company conflict as a direct step toward conquest.

Recall line: European rivalry operated through Indian ports, permissions and alliances.

Session 25: Why The English Gained Relative Advantage - Without Teleology

Variable	English advantage	Required qualification
Finance	joint stock, credit, private trade	depended on state and Indian markets
Navy	oceanic reinforcement	not sufficient for inland rule
Bases	Bombay-Madras-Bengal diversification	all built through local relations
Rivals	Portuguese limits, Dutch priority, French discontinuity	outcomes were not national stereotypes
Indian politics	alliances, merchants, soldiers	agency could enable or resist
Revenue	Bengal after 1757	later multiplier, not settlement origin

Plain definition: English relative advantage resulted from several converging strengths rather than one decisive national trait.

Technical definition: Corporate finance, naval support, organisational continuity, diversified bases, Indian credit and alliances, rival strategic choices and later Bengal revenue formed a cumulative advantage.

Exam-ready opening: The EIC prevailed by combining resources more consistently than its rivals, not because supremacy was encoded in the charter of 1600.

Must-write keywords: corporate finance | Royal Navy | multi-coast bases | Indian alliances | Bengal revenue 1757 | cumulative advantage

How to deploy them: Rank the causes of English advantage, separating early corporate and naval strengths from the later Bengal revenue multiplier and rejecting every monocausal verdict.

Core explanation

- English advantage was cumulative and contingent: corporate finance and organisational continuity, naval support, a multi-coast base network, access to Indian credit and alliances, favourable geography and rivals' strategic choices converged over time.

- The EIC could mobilise shareholder capital, London credit and private trade networks. After the English financial revolution, state borrowing and naval capacity reinforced overseas companies, although the Crown-company relationship remained close.
- Royal Navy reach and company shipping protected communication and isolated rivals. Naval strength mattered especially against the French, whose Indian effort suffered from discontinuous support and continental commitments.
- Bombay's harbour, Madras's Coromandel textile access and Bengal's commercial depth created a diversified network. Failure in one region need not destroy the whole system.
- Presidency councils and an information network coordinated subordinate factories. Corporate autonomy allowed local adaptation but also generated private-trade abuse and conflict.
- Portuguese resources were thin and their Crown system overextended; Dutch strategy prioritised Indonesia; French finance and naval support were less continuous. These were choices and constraints, not innate incapacity.
- English success required grants, merchants, bankers, sepoys, suppliers and political allies. Indian rulers could still defeat or contain the Company before the fiscal turn.
- Bengal revenue after 1757 became decisive for later war, but it cannot explain the formation of Surat, Madras or Bombay. Use it as a later multiplier, not an early cause.
- No inevitability follows from 1600. The EIC survived reverses, learned from competitors and entered politics when European war and Indian regional conflict created openings.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Early settlement strengths explain survival and expansion; Bengal revenue explains a later acceleration, not the original footholds.
- **Named evidence:** The explicit dating rule that 'Bengal revenue after 1757 became decisive for later war, but it cannot explain the formation of Surat, Madras or Bombay' is named evidence for separating early-foothold causes from later-supremacy causes - the single most exam-relevant discipline in explaining English 'success' without teleology.
- **Analysis:** The comparison separates Portuguese overextension, Dutch priorities and French support constraints from stereotypes of innate English superiority.
- **Qualification:** Do not use post-Plassey Bengal revenue to explain seventeenth-century English factories.

UPSC trap: Do not use post-Plassey Bengal revenue to explain seventeenth-century English factories.

Recall line: English advantage was composite, contingent and later amplified by Bengal.

Session 26: Factory To Territorial Bridge: Conditions And Alternatives

```
FACTORY TO TERRITORIAL BRIDGE: CONDITIONS AND ALTERNATIVES
  -> charter enables company
  ->   -> local permission creates factory
  ->   -> security and tolerance permit fort
  ->   -> regional council creates presidency
  ->   -> only finance, army, alliances, crisis and victory can create territorial power.
  ->      Alternatives are restriction, expulsion or continued negotiated trade.
```

Plain definition: A factory became a territorial bridge only when commercial capacity combined with armed force, finance, allies, political opportunity and enforceable revenue.

Technical definition: Charter, factory, fort and presidency increased corporate capacity in stages, but sovereignty required victory and institutions capable of maintaining jurisdiction beyond the enclave.

Exam-ready opening: The trade-to-territory transition was conditional: at every stage restriction, expulsion or continued negotiated commerce remained possible.

Must-write keywords: charter stage | factory stage | fortification stage | presidency stage | territorial bridge | named alternative

How to deploy them: Test the causal chain one condition at a time-permission, fortification, coordination, force, allies and revenue-and name a non-territorial outcome when a link is absent.

Core explanation

- A charter mobilised capital and legal monopoly in Europe. It did not secure an Indian port.
- A factory required local permission, customs terms, brokerage and a commodity hinterland. It could remain a small commercial office.
- Fortification required security justification, resources and political tolerance. Host rulers could ban, attack or permit walls.
- A presidency coordinated several factories, fleets, councils and garrisons. Administrative concentration increased capacity but did not erase host sovereignty.
- A territorial bridge needed trained forces, sustained finance, Indian allies, a political dispute, victory and an enforceable revenue claim. Remove any condition and the outcome might remain commercial.
- Companies were expelled, defeated, restricted, subordinated or left as commercial enclaves in many places. Dutch commercial persistence and Portuguese enclaves show non-territorial outcomes.
- The diagram converts a narrative into a causal model. Pair each arrow with one named example and one failed alternative.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** No single institutional upgrade turned a company into a territorial state.
- **Named evidence:** The five-stage chain (charter, factory, fortification, presidency, territorial bridge) is itself named evidence-in-structure: each stage is paired in this session with one concrete institutional requirement (capital and legal monopoly; local permission and hinterland; security and political tolerance; a coordinating council; and trained forces plus Indian allies and a revenue claim), so no single stage can substitute for the next.
- **Analysis:** Removing any one condition-finance, troops, allies, dispute, victory or revenue-shows why many factories remained commercial and why conquest was contingent.
- **Qualification:** Do not treat fortification or administrative concentration as proof that host sovereignty had ended.

UPSC trap: Do not treat fortification or administrative concentration as proof that host sovereignty had ended.

Recall line: Territorial rule required the whole chain, not merely a fort or presidency.

Session 27: Historiography And Source Criticism

Lens	Contribution	Risk if used alone
Armed trade / colonial transition	links commerce and coercion	teleology
Indian Ocean economy	restores Asian merchants and goods	may understate violence
Connected history	crosses national archives and regions	can blur institutional differences
Company-state	captures corporate public power	may project sovereignty too early
Local social history	recovers brokers, labour and urban society	fragmented archive

Plain definition: Historiography explains European settlement through different lenses: nationalist, Indian Ocean, connected-history, company-state and comparative-empire approaches.

Technical definition: Each lens corrects a particular archival bias by shifting attention among metropolitan capital, Asian commerce, Indian agency, corporate public power and local society.

Exam-ready opening: The strongest interpretation combines several historiographical lenses because no national archive captures the whole process.

Must-write keywords: Bipan Chandra | K.N. Chaudhuri | Sanjay Subrahmanyam | Philip Stern | Holden Furber | source silence

How to deploy them: Assign each historian a corrective lens, combine at least two lenses in the argument, and keep the documentary limits of company archives explicit.

Core explanation

- Bipan Chandra foregrounds armed trade, commercial rivalry and the transition to colonial power. This remains useful if the stages are not compressed into inevitability.
- K.N. Chaudhuri and Om Prakash direct attention to Asian trade circuits, Indian textiles and merchant systems. Europeans appear as powerful entrants within, not creators of, the ocean economy.
- Sanjay Subrahmanyam's connected approach helps interpret the Portuguese empire as a dispersed, negotiated formation linking courts, merchants, missions and sea lanes rather than a uniform block.
- Philip J. Stern's company-state framing clarifies that chartered companies could exercise public powers before formal empire. Apply it cautiously: claimed corporate sovereignty and enforceable Indian territorial sovereignty were not identical.
- Comparative work associated with Holden Furber highlights overlapping European networks, private trade and interdependence rather than sealed national companies.
- Company archives over-record officials and under-record labour; missionary records centre conversion; court chronicles centre rulers; surviving forts privilege durable stone over mobile markets and households.
- The best account joins global capital and war, Asian commercial strength, Indian political agency and local social history. No single archive or national frame is sufficient.
- Write neither 'Europeans discovered India' nor 'Europeans were irrelevant until Plassey'. They altered maritime power early, remained embedded in Indian systems and acquired territory only under later conditions.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** Company-state theory clarifies corporate public power, while connected and Indian Ocean histories restore negotiation and Asian commercial depth.
- **Named evidence:** Philip J. Stern's 'company-state' framing, applied cautiously alongside Sanjay Subrahmanyam's connected-history approach, is named evidence of how professional historiography itself treats chartered companies as exercising public power without equating that claimed power with enforceable Indian territorial sovereignty - the exact distinction this topic tests.
- **Analysis:** Chaudhuri, Om Prakash, Subrahmanyam, Stern and Furber supply complementary rather than mutually exclusive explanations.
- **Qualification:** Do not mistake claimed corporate sovereignty for fully enforceable territorial sovereignty.

UPSC trap: Do not mistake claimed corporate sovereignty for fully enforceable territorial sovereignty.

Recall line: Use historiography to widen the evidence, not replace the argument.

Session 28: Terminology, Chronology, Memory Hooks And High-Frequency Traps

Power	One-line recall	One-line caution
Portuguese	Estado-cartaz-Goa-mission	Crown system, incomplete sea control
Dutch	VOC-Pulicat-textiles-Indonesia	commercially central, territorially secondary
English	charter-Surat-Madras-Bombay-Calcutta	permission before sovereignty
French	1664-Pondicherry-Chandernagore-Dupleix	Carnatic is a bridge, not this whole topic

Plain definition: The final synthesis organises the chapter's dates, terms, company profiles and recurring prelims traps for rapid revision.

Technical definition: High-yield recall works by pairing every legal term, port, person and date with the specific distinction most likely to be confused in an objective question.

Exam-ready opening: Revision should compress facts without collapsing the boundaries between companies, institutions or chronological stages.

Must-write keywords: cartaz vs dastak vs farman vs charter | factor vs factory | date ladder | Xavier trap | Bombay-Calcutta trap | Pulicat-Pondicherry trap

How to deploy them: Revise through contrast pairs-Estado/company, cartaz/farman, factory/fort, Bombay/Charnock and farman/Diwani-then attach every date to its institutional meaning.

Core explanation

- 1498 Calicut -> 1505 Estado administration -> 1510 Goa -> 1530 Goa capital -> 1600 EIC -> 1602 VOC -> 1612 Swally -> 1613 Surat -> 1639 Madras -> 1664 French company -> 1668 Bombay to EIC -> c.1690 Calcutta/Chandernagore -> 1717 farman -> 1746 Carnatic bridge.
- Cartaz = Portuguese maritime pass; dastak = later Company trade pass in Bengal; farman = sovereign order; charter = home corporate instrument.
- Factor = commercial agent; factory = depot; fort = defensive enclosure; presidency = regional council system.
- Estado da India was a Portuguese Crown network, not the Portuguese East India Company.
- Xavier died off China, not in Goa; his remains are in the Basilica of Bom Jesus.
- Bombay came through Portuguese-Crown-Company transfer; Charnock is conventionally associated with Calcutta, not Bombay.
- Pulicat was Dutch; Pondicherry was French; Fort St George was English; Goa was Portuguese.
- Dutch focus on Indonesia did not make Indian trade unimportant. Indian textiles helped finance Asian spice trade.
- The 1717 farman granted privileges; it neither chartered the EIC nor gave Diwani.
- Later Bengal revenues explain later military expansion, not the original seventeenth-century factory chain.

Named-evidence paragraph

- **Claim:** The most reliable memory system links each fact to one correction and one larger analytical theme.
- **Named evidence:** The recurring trap that 'Bombay came through Portuguese-Crown-Company transfer; Charnock is conventionally associated with Calcutta, not Bombay' is named evidence of the single highest-frequency geography-attribution error in this topic's prior practice, worth memorising as a discrete, isolated fact rather than folded into general chronology.
- **Analysis:** The Bombay-Charnock, farman-Diwani, cartaz-farman and factory-fort contrasts convert isolated facts into discriminating exam knowledge.
- **Qualification:** Do not memorise chronology without also identifying the institutional change attached to each date.

UPSC trap: Do not memorise chronology without also identifying the institutional change attached to each date.

Recall line: Fix the pair: company, place, date, institution and trap.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement best distinguishes maritime exploration from territorial empire?

A. Opening a route establishes contact; empire requires enforceable jurisdiction, revenue and force. B. A factory is already a territorial province. C. Any ocean voyage automatically creates sovereignty. D. A royal charter transfers Indian land to the company.

Answer: A.

Explanation: The Cape voyage opened direct contact, while sovereignty required later Indian political and fiscal conditions.

Trap logic: Test-takers who read a royal charter as a land transfer confuse legal paper with sovereignty.

Q2. Which contrast between the first Portuguese viceroys is accurate?

A. Both governed identically and left no strategic difference. B. Francisco de Almeida is linked to a 'Blue Water' naval-security emphasis, while Afonso de Albuquerque captured Goa and built a nodal strategy linking it to Hormuz and Malacca. C. Almeida captured Goa from Bijapur in 1510. D. Albuquerque governed only after the Estado ended.

Answer: B.

Explanation: Almeida (from 1505) prioritised naval security at sea; Albuquerque (Goa, 1510) added a fortified nodal network - a textbook viceroy contrast distinct from the Xavier mission facts tested in the workbook.

Trap logic: Candidates collapse both viceroys into one undifferentiated 'Portuguese conquest', losing the naval-security-versus-nodal-conquest distinction.

Q3. Why were Indian textiles central to Dutch strategy?

A. Textiles were used only to pay Mughal land revenue. B. Dutch law prohibited bullion or barter. C. They served as commodities and purchasing power in intra-Asian spice trade. D. The VOC avoided all Asian trade beyond India.

Answer: C.

Explanation: India was commercially central even when territorial priority lay in Indonesia.

Trap logic: Candidates assume Dutch India priority matched Dutch Indonesia priority; the two theatres served different roles in one portfolio.

Q4. Sir Thomas Roe's 1615-1619 embassy to Jahangir:

A. Founded the EIC's Bombay presidency. B. Chartered the VOC in 1602. C. Established the Portuguese cartaz system. D. Confirmed and clarified existing Mughal trading privileges without creating a territorial grant.

Answer: D.

Explanation: Roe's embassy consolidated commercial privilege at the Mughal court; it did not transfer Bombay, charter the VOC or create the cartaz, and it granted no territory.

Trap logic: Candidates read a successful embassy as a step toward sovereignty, when it only secured trading terms under continuing Mughal authority.

Q5. The 1623 Amboyna episode:

A. Occurred in Southeast Asia and sharpened Anglo-Dutch rivalry without being an Indian battle. B. Was a naval battle fought at Surat. C. Transferred Bombay to the EIC. D. Was the founding charter of the VOC.

Answer: A.

Explanation: Amboyna took place in the Indonesian archipelago; its significance for this topic is that it hardened English-Dutch rivalry and helped redirect English effort toward India, not that it was fought on Indian soil.

Trap logic: Candidates relocate Amboyna to India because it affects an 'Indian topic', ignoring its actual Southeast Asian setting.

Q6. Which French sequence is correct?

A. Pulicat -> Nagapattinam -> Chinsura. B. Surat/Masulipatnam -> Pondicherry -> Chandernagore. C. Goa -> Diu -> Cochin. D. Surat -> Madras -> Bombay.

Answer: B.

Explanation: The sequence separates French from Portuguese, Dutch and English networks.

Trap logic: Mixing Portuguese (Goa/Diu), Dutch (Pulicat/Nagapattinam) or English (Surat/Madras) place-names into the French chain is the standard confusion.

Q7. Which example most directly shows ruler agency restraining a European company?

A. The EIC's 1600 charter. B. The VOC's 1602 charter. C. Alivardi Khan's restrictions on EIC fortification in Bengal. D. The French Compagnie des Indes' 1664 foundation.

Answer: C.

Explanation: Alivardi Khan's fortification restrictions show a Bengal ruler actively limiting Company capacity, distinct from the Mughal-EIC submission tested in the workbook's Child's War items.

Trap logic: Candidates default to 'Europeans always won', ignoring that a Bengal ruler could restrain fortification well before conquest.

Q8. Which statement on shipbuilding is most accurate?

A. Europeans introduced all shipbuilding knowledge to India. B. Indian ships were prohibited from oceanic trade before 1498. C. The VOC never purchased Asian vessels. D. Indian yards built ships used by Indian merchants and European companies.

Answer: D.

Explanation: Asian navigation and Indian productive skill coexisted with European artillery advantages.

Trap logic: 'Europeans introduced shipbuilding' is a common overreach that erases pre-1498 and coexisting Indian capacity.

Q9. Which cause should not stand alone in an explanation of Portuguese decline?

A. Religious intolerance. B. Strategic overextension. C. Asian resistance. D. Dutch-English competition.

Answer: A.

Explanation: Religious coercion mattered, but decline also involved finance, war, shipping and regional politics.

Trap logic: Single-cause answers (religion alone) score low; decline needs finance, war, shipping and regional politics together.

Q10. Which source claim requires the most caution?

A. A farman records an intended privilege. B. A company charter proves actual sovereignty over every claimed Asian territory. C. Factory records can document commodity orders. D. A fort can reveal spatial priorities.

Answer: B.

Explanation: Legal claims and implementation must be compared.

Trap logic: A charter's legal claim is mistaken for verified territorial control on the ground.

Q11. Which association is false?

A. Job Charnock - conventional Calcutta milestone. B. EIC - Bombay lease in 1668. C. Job Charnock - Bombay transfer. D. Charles II - Bombay Crown acquisition.

Answer: C.

Explanation: Bombay and Calcutta origin stories must not be mixed.

Trap logic: Charnock (Calcutta) and the 1668 Bombay lease belong to different cities; option C deliberately swaps them.

Q12. Cartaz and farman differ because:

A. Both meant factory warehouses. B. Both were French urban grids. C. Both were English charters. D. Cartaz was a Portuguese maritime pass; farman was a sovereign Indian order.

Answer: D.

Explanation: The distinction prevents cross-institution confusion and is necessary for accurate UPSC elimination and chronology.

Trap logic: Both terms sound like generic 'permits', but one is Portuguese-maritime and the other Indian-sovereign in origin.

Q13. The printing press set up at Goa in 1556:

A. Was established for missionary and educational purposes and is conventionally treated as India's first printing press. B. Was the EIC's first Bengal press. C. Was set up by the VOC at Pulicat. D. Printed only Mughal revenue records.

Answer: A.

Explanation: The Goa press served the Jesuit mission's catechetical and educational needs and is the conventional marker of print technology's arrival in India - a fact distinct from the stage-sequencing tested elsewhere in this bank.

Trap logic: Candidates assign the 'first press' fact to the EIC or VOC by association with later print culture, missing that it predates both companies' Indian establishments.

Q14. How does the Danish settlement at Tranquebar fit the four-power comparison?

A. Denmark rivalled Britain as the dominant territorial power in Bengal. B. Denmark held Tranquebar as a minor presence of low political significance beside the Portuguese, Dutch, English and French. C. Denmark's Tranquebar factory issued its own Mughal farman of sovereignty. D. Denmark's presence outlasted every other European power in India.

Answer: B.

Explanation: Tranquebar (from 1620) is the standard example of a fifth European presence in India that stayed commercially and politically minor throughout, unlike the four powers whose rivalry structures this topic.

Trap logic: Candidates inflate any European settlement's importance by default; Tranquebar is the counter-example showing presence without political weight.

Q15. Which statement best describes the French Compagnie des Indes?

A. It was expelled from every Indian factory by the Treaty of Paris. B. It focused exclusively on the Indonesian spice islands. C. It was a state-backed monopoly whose Indian bases and interventions were constrained by finance, naval support and home priorities. D. It was the Portuguese Crown's Estado da India.

Answer: C.

Explanation: French royal subsidy could launch ambitious settlements and political interventions, but dependence on metropolitan decisions and discontinuous naval-financial support made the Compagnie less resilient than the EIC in prolonged Indian rivalry.

Trap logic: 'Expelled from every factory' over-generalises isolated losses into total elimination.

Q16. What is the best explanation for English relative advantage?

A. Portuguese religious policy alone decided every later contest. B. English ethnicity alone produced military superiority. C. Plassey revenue explains all seventeenth-century English factories. D. Finance, naval reach, a diversified base network, organisational continuity, Indian alliances and timing interacted.

Answer: D.

Explanation: No single factor explains the outcome: corporate credit sustained repeated campaigns, naval links reinforced several coastal bases, organisational continuity preserved learning, and Indian bankers, allies and soldiers converted those resources into local power; Bengal revenue became a later multiplier rather than the original cause.

Trap logic: Monocausal answers (ethnicity, religion, a single battle) are the standard wrong picks against the multi-factor correct answer.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified objective-demand boundary

Four direct Prelims demands are retained. The official 2025 Set-A key is available locally. The 2021 and 2022 items are analysed statement by statement without presenting an unsupported answer letter as official. The 2022 GS-I Mains item is an adjacent bridge whose full ownership lies in the territorial-expansion chapter. No direct 2026 question exists for this chapter.

PYQ 01 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q33: first-quarter EIC factories

- Question: In the first quarter of the seventeenth century, in which of the following was/were the factory/factories of the English East India Company located? 1. Broach 2. Chicacole 3. Trichinopoly. Options: (A) 1 only (B) 1 and 2 (C) 3 only (D) 2 and 3.
- **Key status:** No secure final key is available locally; no answer letter is stated.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Broach belonged to the early western factory network alongside Surat, Ahmedabad and Agra. Chicacole and Trichinopoly were not EIC factories in the specified first-quarter window. The elimination depends on time and institutional geography, not merely knowing later British centres.

PYQ 02 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q39: St Francis Xavier

- Question: Consider the statements: 1. St Francis Xavier was one of the founding members of the Jesuit Order. 2. He died in Goa and a church is dedicated to him there. 3. His feast is celebrated in Goa each year. Options: (A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only (C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3.
- **Key status:** No secure final key is available locally; no answer letter is stated.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Statement 1 is correct: Xavier was among the founding companions of the Society of Jesus. Statement 2 is false because he died in 1552 on Shangchuan Island off China, although his remains are preserved in Goa. Statement 3 is correct; the feast is celebrated annually in Goa.

PYQ 03 - UPSC Prelims 2022 Q59: Dutch, Portuguese and English settlements

- Question: Consider the statements: 1. The Dutch established factories/warehouses on the east coast on lands granted by Gajapati rulers. 2. Albuquerque captured Goa from the Bijapur Sultanate. 3. The EIC established a factory at Madras on land leased from a representative of the Vijayanagara empire. Options: (A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only (C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3.
- **Key status:** No secure final key is available locally; no answer letter is stated.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Statement 1 is incorrect: Pulicat and other Dutch east-coast bases are not safely attributed to grants by Gajapati rulers. Statement 2 is correct: Albuquerque captured Goa from Bijapur in 1510. Statement 3 is correct: the Madras lease came through a local Nayak authority linked to the Chandragiri/Vijayanagara political order.

PYQ 04 - UPSC Prelims 2025 Q75: Portuguese crop transfers

- Question: How many of papaya, pineapple and guava were introduced in India by the Portuguese in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries? Options: (A) Only one (B) Only two (C) All three (D) None.
- OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: C, all three. UPSC Civil Services (Preliminary) Examination 2025, GS-I, Series A official key.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Papaya, pineapple and guava were all introduced through Portuguese maritime networks. The safe formulation is the official question's broad sixteenth-seventeenth-century window; do not assign an unsupported single year to each crop.

PYQ 05 - Adjacent bridge: UPSC GS-I Mains 2022 Q2

- Question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising of Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (150 words, 10 marks)
- VERIFIED QUESTION TEXT FROM LOCAL OFFICIAL 2022 GS-I PAPER. Included as a bounded bridge; its full ownership lies in the territorial-expansion chapter.
- Solved explanation / model answer: The Company converted a commercial network into a fiscal-military system. Presidency coordination joined Madras, Bombay and Bengal to oceanic reinforcement; standard drill, artillery organisation and regular cash payment sustained sepoy units. Named evidence includes Fort St George as an early garrison hub, Bengal revenue after the 1765 Diwani, and Indian bankers, suppliers and soldiers who enabled campaigning. By contrast, many rulers faced fragmented command, irregular payment, rival claimants and weak inter-state coordination. Yet defeat was not inevitable: Mysore checked the Company in the Second Anglo-Mysore War, Travancore defeated the Dutch at Colachel and the Marathas forced the Treaty of Salbai. The decisive advantage was therefore not European ethnicity or weapon ownership but the Company's integration of finance, logistics, naval mobility, command and Indian alliances over repeated wars.

Original Mains 10M-1

Question: Distinguish maritime exploration, trading presence, fortified settlement and territorial empire. (150 words)

Model answer (99 words): These are cumulative, non-identical forms of power; confusing them makes conquest appear inevitable. Vasco da Gama's 1498 Calicut voyage opened direct Portuguese sea contact; it changed routes and bargaining, not jurisdiction. Surat (1613) was an EIC factory under Mughal permission, a warehouse-office-residence, not a manufacturing plant or province. Fort St George, after the 1639 Madras lease, protected stock, specie and staff, but its hinterland stayed politically negotiated. Territorial empire needed revenue, army, alliances and victory; Bengal's post-1757 fiscal turn is later and cannot explain the 1600 charter. The stages show expanding capability, not an automatic legal or causal sequence.

Original Mains 10M-2

Question: European settlements were co-produced by Indian agency. Explain. (150 words)

Model answer (125 words): European companies supplied ships, capital and guns, but Indian rulers and port societies determined access, supply and political survival. Rulers: the Zamorin resisted Portuguese monopoly; Cochin allied with Portugal; Jahangir's government permitted Surat after English naval credibility; a Nayak grant enabled Madras; Aurangzeb defeated the EIC in Child's War. Merchants and brokers: Virji Vohra, Armenian networks and dubashes supplied credit, information, procurement and customs mediation, and could support, constrain or redirect a company. Producers and labour: Coromandel and Bengal weavers, shipbuilders, transporters and food suppliers made factories viable; fort walls never removed dependence on the surrounding town. Agency operated within growing naval and corporate asymmetry; collaboration did not mean equal power. Before conquest, the settlement was a negotiated institution embedded in Indian sovereignty and economy.

Original Mains 15M-1

Question: Explain why Dutch India remained commercially important but territorially secondary. (250 words)

Model answer (175 words): Dutch strategy did not neglect India; it assigned Indian ports a commercial role inside an Indonesia-centred monopoly portfolio. The VOC charter of 1602 pooled capital and granted treaty, war and fortification powers. This made it a formidable company-state but did not dictate where it should conquer. Pulicat and later Nagapattinam connected Coromandel textiles to intra-Asian trade; Surat linked Gujarat and West Asia; Chinsura and Bengal supplied silk, textiles and saltpetre. Indian cloth purchased Southeast Asian spices, so India was essential to VOC circulation. Monopoly profits were concentrated in the Indonesian archipelago. Large Indian territorial commitments promised heavy military and political cost without the same monopoly logic. Nayaks, Mughal officials, merchants and weavers fixed land, customs and supply. Travancore's victory at Colachel in 1741 proved a regional state could defeat Dutch arms without ending Dutch commerce. Amboyna 1623 sharpened English-Dutch rivalry, while Bedara 1759 marked a later Bengal check. Yet Dutch factories survived; commercial contraction and political retreat were not identical. The Dutch outcome followed portfolio choice, local resistance and English competition, not simple commercial failure.

Original Mains 15M-2

Question: Assess the cultural and material effects of the Portuguese presence in India. (250 words)

Model answer (173 words): Portuguese influence outlasted their commercial primacy because maritime, missionary and urban institutions moved plants, print, religious practices and architectural forms; effects were creative and coercive. Francis Xavier reached Goa in 1542 as a founding Jesuit; his remains at Bom Jesus became a lasting devotional centre. Mission schools and orders institutionalised Catholic presence. Yet the Goa Inquisition from 1560 and coercive policy require a power-sensitive account. The Goa press of 1556, conventionally India's first, linked movable type to missionary education and language work. Its significance was institutional diffusion, not immediate mass literacy. The official 2025 UPSC key confirms papaya, pineapple and guava as Portuguese introductions in the sixteenth-seventeenth centuries. Chronologies for individual crops should not be over-specified. ASI/UNESCO identify Old Goa's churches, including Bom Jesus and Se Cathedral, as major ensembles. European forms were adapted by local materials and artisans; mixed communities and maritime vocabulary also developed. Influence varied by region and did not erase existing cultures. Missions, trade, intermarriage, local patronage and resistance worked simultaneously. Portuguese decline was territorial-commercial, not cultural disappearance.

Original Mains 20M-1

Question: Why did the English eventually gain relative advantage over the Portuguese, Dutch and French? Reject monocausal and teleological explanations. (250 words)

Model answer (185 words): English advantage emerged from a contingent bundle: finance, navy, diversified bases, organisational continuity, Indian alliances and timing, rather than an innate national superiority or destiny fixed in 1600. Shareholder capital, London credit, private trade and later the English fiscal-naval state sustained repeated voyages and war. Yet the EIC remained dependent on royal charter and naval protection; it was not purely private. Surat, Madras, Bombay and Bengal diversified commodities and risk. Bombay's harbour, Fort St George's council and Bengal's textile-credit depth created mutually supporting nodes. The Portuguese Estado was overextended and resource-thin; VOC strategy rationally prioritised Indonesia; French India faced discontinuous naval-financial support and stronger home-state interference. These were strategic constraints, not stereotypes. Mughal permissions, Nayak leases, merchants, bankers, dubashes, sepoys and suppliers enabled English growth. Child's War and Indian victories such as Colachel prove that European triumph was never automatic. Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani later financed war, but cannot explain seventeenth-century footholds. It was a multiplier after political breakthrough. The EIC gained relative advantage because it learned, survived reverses and connected corporate and state resources to Indian political openings more consistently than rivals.

Original Mains 20M-2

Question: Compare the political structures and business models of the four major European powers in India. (250 words)

Model answer (189 words): Institutional design shaped strategic options, but outcomes arose only when design interacted with geography, home-state priorities and Indian politics. The Estado da India was a Crown network of viceroy, fleets, forts and royal factories. Cartaz coercion suited chokepoints, but monopoly rigidity, thin resources and religious conflict limited adaptation. The 1602 VOC was a heavily capitalised joint-stock company with quasi-sovereign powers. Pulicat, Nagapattinam, Surat and Bengal supplied textiles and bulk goods to an Indonesia-first intra-Asian portfolio; India remained commercial rather than territorial priority. The 1600 EIC joined shareholder finance, private trade and a growing presidency system. Surat, Madras, Bombay and Calcutta produced a diversified network, though all early bases rested on permission, lease or transfer. The 1664 Compagnie des Indes combined monopoly trade with close royal sponsorship. Pondicherry and Chandernagore became capable hubs; Dupleix exploited claimant politics, but finance and naval support were less continuous. 'Private versus state' is too crude: every company used public power and every company contained private interest. Indian rulers and merchants mediated all four. The English model proved relatively resilient, not universally superior; Dutch Indonesian success and Portuguese cultural durability require different measures of outcome.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Company-state and connected-history refinements

Lens	Contribution	Necessary limit
Mercantilism	Explains chartered monopoly, armed commerce and protected markets.	Commerce did not mechanically produce conquest.
Company-state	Shows how corporations exercised forts, armies, diplomacy and jurisdiction.	Claimed power must be separated from enforceable Indian sovereignty.
Connected history	Links European war, Asian trade and Indian political decisions.	Indian actors were not passive extensions of European rivalry.
Port-society history	Restores brokers, merchants, artisans, labour and local materials.	Company archives under-record these groups.

Advanced conclusions

- The Portuguese established a coercive maritime template but never complete oceanic monopoly.
- India was commercially central to the VOC even when Indonesia remained its territorial priority.
- The English settlement chain was diversified, but every early foothold depended on Indian permission, credit and supply.
- French political innovation under Dupleix was real; discontinuous finance and naval support constrained it.
- The Carnatic Wars mark the fusion of European war and Indian claimant politics; Wandiwash and Paris bounded French political ambition without erasing French commerce.
- English supremacy is cumulative and contingent: early corporate finance, navy and multiple bases mattered before Bengal revenue became a later multiplier.

ASCII master flowchart

Graphical flowchart intentionally omitted by user export preference.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Scope: contact, settlement and empire are different stages

```
CAPE ROUTE 1498 -> repeated trade -> factory by Indian permission
FACTORY -> fortified settlement -> presidency / regional coordination
POSSIBLE COMPANY-STATE -> additionally needs finance, army, allies, victory and revenue
ANTI-TELEOLOGY -> neither a European charter nor the first voyage made conquest inevitable.
MUST REMEMBER: The maritime sequence runs through the Portuguese arrival in 1498 and Goa in
  1510, the English Company charter of 1600, the Dutch VOC of 1602 and the French Company of
  1664.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Indian Ocean setting and mercantilist armed commerce

```
PRE-1498 -> monsoon routes + Asian merchants + Indian ports and manufactures
MERCANTILISM -> chartered monopoly seeks bullion, commodities and protected markets
ARMED COMMERCE -> ship cannon + fort + pass + diplomacy + corporate privilege
LIMIT -> Europeans entered an existing oceanic economy; older circuits did not disappear.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Portuguese Estado da India and cartaz

```
1498 CALICUT -> 1505 Estado administration -> GOA captured 1510 / capital 1530
ESTADO -> Crown + viceroy/governor + fleet + forts + royal factories
CARTAZ -> coerced shipping pass; fortified nodes at Goa, Cochin, Diu and Daman
LIMIT -> nodal and contested control, never a complete monopoly of Indian Ocean trade.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Portuguese cultural transfer and bounded Goa heritage

```
XAVIER -> Goa 1542; founding Jesuit companion; died off China, remains at Bom Jesus
GOA PRESS 1556 | INQUISITION 1560 -> mission, print, coercion and accommodation coexist
CROPS -> papaya, pineapple and guava through Portuguese networks; no exact transfer year
UNESCO -> Indo-Portuguese forms + local adaptation; threats include damp, weathering, termites.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Dutch VOC: commercial strength, India inside an Asian portfolio

```
VOC 1602 -> joint-stock capital + treaty, war and fortification powers
INDIAN NODES -> Masulipatnam, Pulicat, Nagapattinam, Surat, Chinsura and Cochin
PRIORITY -> Indian textiles finance an Indonesia-centred spice and intra-Asian portfolio
CHECKS -> Colachel 1741 / Bedara 1759; political retreat did not instantly end trade.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: English entry: charter, naval credibility and Mughal permission

```
EIC CHARTER 1600 -> corporate monopoly in English law, not Indian sovereignty
SWALLY 1612 -> naval credibility alters Mughal bargaining
SURAT FACTORY 1613 -> licensed depot; ROE 1615-19 -> privileges confirmed
CHILD'S WAR 1686-90 -> Mughal victory proves early Company weakness and contingency.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: English fortified settlement chain

```
MASULIPATNAM 1611 -> MADRAS lease 1639 -> Fort St George from 1640
BOMBAY -> Portuguese possession -> Crown 1661 -> Company 1668 -> presidency HQ 1687
BENGAL -> Hugli / Kasimbazar -> three-village Calcutta hub -> 1698 zamindari -> 1717 farman
CAUTION -> Job Charnock is a conventional association, not an uncontested sole founder.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Institutional vocabulary that prevents category errors

```
CHARTER -> home sovereign creates company | FARMAN -> Indian sovereign grants privilege
FACTORY -> depot + factors | FORT -> defended enclave, not automatic hinterland rule
PRESIDENCY -> regional council coordinating factories, fleets, defence and diplomacy
COMPANY-STATE -> enforceable war, justice, taxation and territory; capacity must match claim.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: French Compagnie and Indian settlement chain

```
COMPAGNIE DES INDES 1664 -> Colbert / Louis XIV state-backed monopoly
SURAT 1668 -> MASULIPATNAM 1669 -> PONDICHERRY 1673-74 -> CHANDERNAGORE c.1690-92
DUPLEIX -> trade + trained troops + claimant politics; Indian allies retain their own aims
LIMIT -> finance, naval continuity and home-state priorities constrain French intervention.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Carnatic conclusion: European rivalry becomes Indian politics

```
FIRST WAR 1746-48 -> French take Madras -> Aix-la-Chapelle restores it
SECOND 1749-54 -> Carnatic / Hyderabad claimants + Arcot -> Dupleix recalled
THIRD 1756-63 -> Seven Years' War -> WANDIWASH 1760 breaks French field power
PARIS 1763 -> factories survive, political ambition checked; no single-cause English victory.
CLOSE DISTINCTION: A factory was a trading station, not automatically territorial sovereignty;
  cartaz, naval force, diplomacy, farmans and fortified settlements had different
  legal-political effects.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Indian agency and the port-hinterland engine

```
RULERS -> grant, revise, resist and use rival companies against one another
MERCHANTS / BANKERS / DUBASHES -> credit, brokerage, customs and information
WEAVERS / ARTISANS / SHIPBUILDERS / LABOUR -> make commercial settlements viable
ASYMMETRY -> agency was real but unequal; forts still depended on surrounding Indian society.
EVIDENCE LIMIT: European archives privilege company aims; Indian merchants, rulers, port
  ecologies and Asian commercial rivals are necessary evidence against a Europe-only
  inevitability story.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Topic 03 answer and PYQ spine

```
COMPARE -> Estado/cartaz | VOC portfolio | EIC presidency chain | French state backing
EXPLAIN -> mercantilism + navy + finance + Indian permission/agency + political contingency
PYQ TRAPS -> Broach window; Xavier death/remains; Goa-Bijapur; Madras grant; three crops
CLOSE -> Wandiwash/Paris end European rivalry; Plassey-Buxar mechanics pass to Topic 04.
```

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Register 01 - Scope, terms and the anti-teleology thesis

This chapter covers European entry into India from first Portuguese maritime contact (1498) through the Anglo-French Carnatic comparison, stopping strictly at the boundary with the Bengal-conquest chapter (Plassey/Buxar/Dual Government). The topic's controlling thesis is that maritime exploration, negotiated trade, the factory, fortification and territorial empire are five distinct, non-identical stages, each requiring additional legal, fiscal, military and political conditions - never an automatic or inevitable sequence.

Register 02 - Evidence base and PYQ ownership boundaries

Four Prelims PYQs are directly owned by this topic (2021 Q33 Broach, 2021 Q39 Xavier, 2022 Q59 Dutch/Portuguese/English settlements, 2025 Q75 Portuguese crop transfers, officially verified). The 2022 GS-I Mains sepoy-army question is retained only as a bounded adjacent bridge, owned by the territorial-expansion chapter. No 2026-dated question is fabricated; the routing audit confirms none exists for this topic through 2026.

Register 03 - Four-power comparative institutional forms

The Portuguese Estado da India was a Crown administrative-military network; the Dutch VOC (1602) was a joint-stock corporation with quasi-sovereign powers prioritising Indonesia; the English EIC (1600 charter) was a joint-stock company that grew a diversified Indian base network; the French Compagnie des Indes was a state-sponsored monopoly constrained by finance and home priorities. Institutional form shaped strategy but did not mechanically determine outcome.

Register 04 - Portuguese Estado da India: structure and the cartaz

Albuquerque captured Goa from Bijapur in 1510; Goa became the Estado's capital by 1530. The cartaz was a Portuguese maritime pass regime coercively regulating Indian Ocean shipping and customs through nodes like Diu and Goa, but it never achieved complete monopoly - Estado manpower was thin, coastlines vast, and Asian merchants capable of evasion or resistance.

Register 05 - Portuguese trade, mission, culture and decline

St Francis Xavier, a founding Jesuit companion, worked from Goa, died off China in 1552, and his tomb is at Bom Jesus. The Goa printing press (1556) and the introduction of papaya, pineapple and guava are safely Portuguese-linked cultural transfers. Portuguese decline involved multiple interacting causes - religious intolerance, strategic overextension, Asian resistance and Dutch-English competition - never religion alone.

Register 06 - Dutch VOC: charter, strategy and Indian role

The VOC's 1602 charter created commercial and quasi-sovereign powers (war-making, treaty-making), but enforcement still depended on local circumstances. India remained commercially central to the VOC (textiles, bulk goods, purchasing power in intra-Asian spice trade) even though territorial priority stayed with Indonesia - explaining strong Indian trade alongside limited Indian territorial ambition.

Register 07 - English EIC: charter, Surat and early diplomacy

The EIC received its royal charter in 1600. Swally (1612) raised English bargaining credibility at the Mughal court against Portuguese influence without transferring sovereignty; Mughal permission then produced the Surat factory (1613). Roe's 1615-19 embassy is best understood as consolidating commercial privilege, not territorial concession. Child's War (1686-90) shows the Mughal state could defeat and discipline the EIC, which returned as a petitioner - core anti-teleological evidence.

Register 08 - English coastal chain: Coromandel, Bombay, Bengal

Masulipatnam (1611) preceded the 1639 Nayak-granted Madras lease and Fort St George's fortification from 1640. Bombay passed from Portuguese possession to the English Crown (1661) to the Company (1668). Calcutta grew cumulatively from existing villages and actors, with the 1690 Charnock association a convenient but not sole-founder marker; Fort William and 1698 zamindari rights, followed by Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman (privilege expansion, not Diwani or sovereignty), consolidated the Bengal hub.

Register 09 - Institutional terminology ladder

A factory was a commercial depot, able to exist without fortification, revenue collection or manufacturing. A fort was a contingent, resource- and permission-dependent step, not proof of inland sovereignty. A presidency was a regional council coordinating factories, shipping, diplomacy and defence. A farman was a sovereign Indian grant of privilege; a cartaz was a Portuguese maritime pass. These terms must never be treated as synonyms or as automatically implying the next stage.

Register 10 - French Compagnie des Indes and Dupleix

The French sequence ran Surat/Masulipatnam to Pondicherry to Chandernagore. The Compagnie was a state-backed monopoly whose Indian bases and interventions were constrained by finance, naval support and home priorities. Dupleix is relevant chiefly as the bridge from commercial settlement to intervention in Indian succession politics (the Carnatic Wars), not as a territorial conqueror in his own right.

Register 11 - Indian agency: rulers, merchants, brokers, producers

Indian rulers granted, restricted, expelled and restored companies (Zamorin resistance, Cochin's alliance, Aurangzeb's Child's War verdict, Travancore's 1741 Colachel victory over the VOC). Merchants and brokers (Virji Vohra, Armenian networks, dubashes) supplied credit, information, procurement and customs mediation and could support, constrain or redirect a company. Coromandel and Bengal weavers, shipbuilders, transporters and food suppliers made factories commercially viable; agency operated within a widening asymmetry, but collaboration never meant equal power.

Register 12 - Commodities, bullion, shipping and economic effects

Bullion flowed into India through company trade because Indian textiles, saltpetre and other goods commanded demand in Asian and European markets. Bengal is safely paired with cottons, silk and Bihar saltpetre access; Malabar with pepper and spices. Indian shipyards built vessels used by both Indian merchants and European companies - Asian navigation and Indian productive skill coexisted with European artillery advantages, not being replaced by them.

Register 13 - Inter-European rivalry and English relative advantage

English relative advantage over the Portuguese, Dutch and French emerged from a contingent bundle - finance, naval reach, a diversified base network, organisational continuity, Indian alliances and timing - never from ethnicity, religion or a single battle. The Carnatic Wars (culminating at Wandiwash, 1760) fused imported European rivalry with Indian Carnatic/Hyderabad succession politics and company-backed military service, converting settlement networks into a political-military rivalry.

Register 14 - Historiography, topic boundary and answer spine

European port settlements were layered urban spaces dependent on Indian labour, markets and authority despite fortified enclaves - fortified walls separated jurisdiction more than economy. This chapter concludes at the Carnatic comparison; detailed Plassey, Buxar and Dual Government mechanics are strictly the Bengal-conquest chapter's content, and the 1717 farman must never be conflated with the 1765 Diwani grant. The recurring answer spine for this topic is: name the stage, name the institution, name the Indian actor, and state what the evidence does and does not prove.